

State Data Profile — Maharashtra

A sample state profile — every India Insight Lab state report follows this same structure.

7 CHAPTERS	39 INDICATORS	18 WITH STATE DATA	1951–2036 PERIOD COVERED
----------------------	-------------------------	------------------------------	------------------------------------

Generated 21 Aug 2026 · assembled from 33 sources

This PDF is a snapshot. Indicators are revised as their sources publish;
indiainsightlab.com always carries the current figures.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This report assembles 39 indicators across 7 chapters, drawn from 33 sources and covering 1951–2036.

Of those indicators, 18 carry state-level detail and can be mapped across India’s states. The remaining 21 are published at national level only by their source, and are shown here as national series without a sub-national breakdown.

Coverage limits. This report contains no district- or city-level figures. Comparable district data is not currently integrated into India Insight Lab, and no value here has been estimated, interpolated or carried down from a higher geography to fill that gap. Where a number is absent, it is absent.

KEY FINDINGS

Each finding below is computed directly from the state values in this report — the highest and lowest recorded state for that indicator. None are authored interpretations.

1 Literacy rate by state

Ranges from 94.0% in Kerala to 61.8% in Bihar — a spread of 32.2% across the 26 states reported.

2 **Multidimensional poverty by state**

Ranges from 33.76% in Bihar to 0.55% in Kerala — a spread of 33.21% across the 25 states reported.

NITI Aayog National MPI — A Progress Review 2023

3 **Slum population share by state**

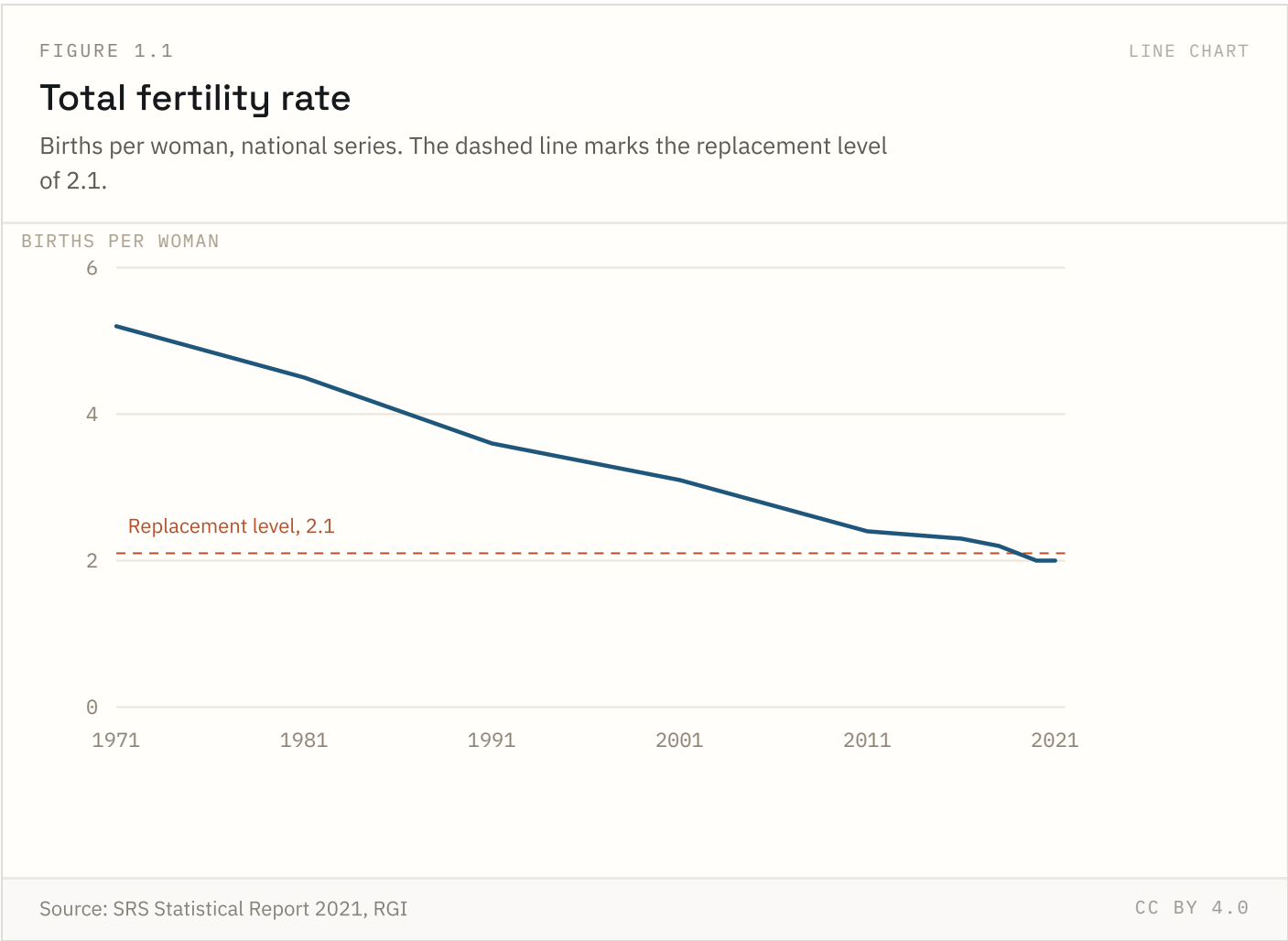
Ranges from 24.0% in Andhra Pradesh to 4.9% in Kerala — a spread of 19.1% across the 15 states reported.

Census of India 2011, Primary Census Abstract for Slum

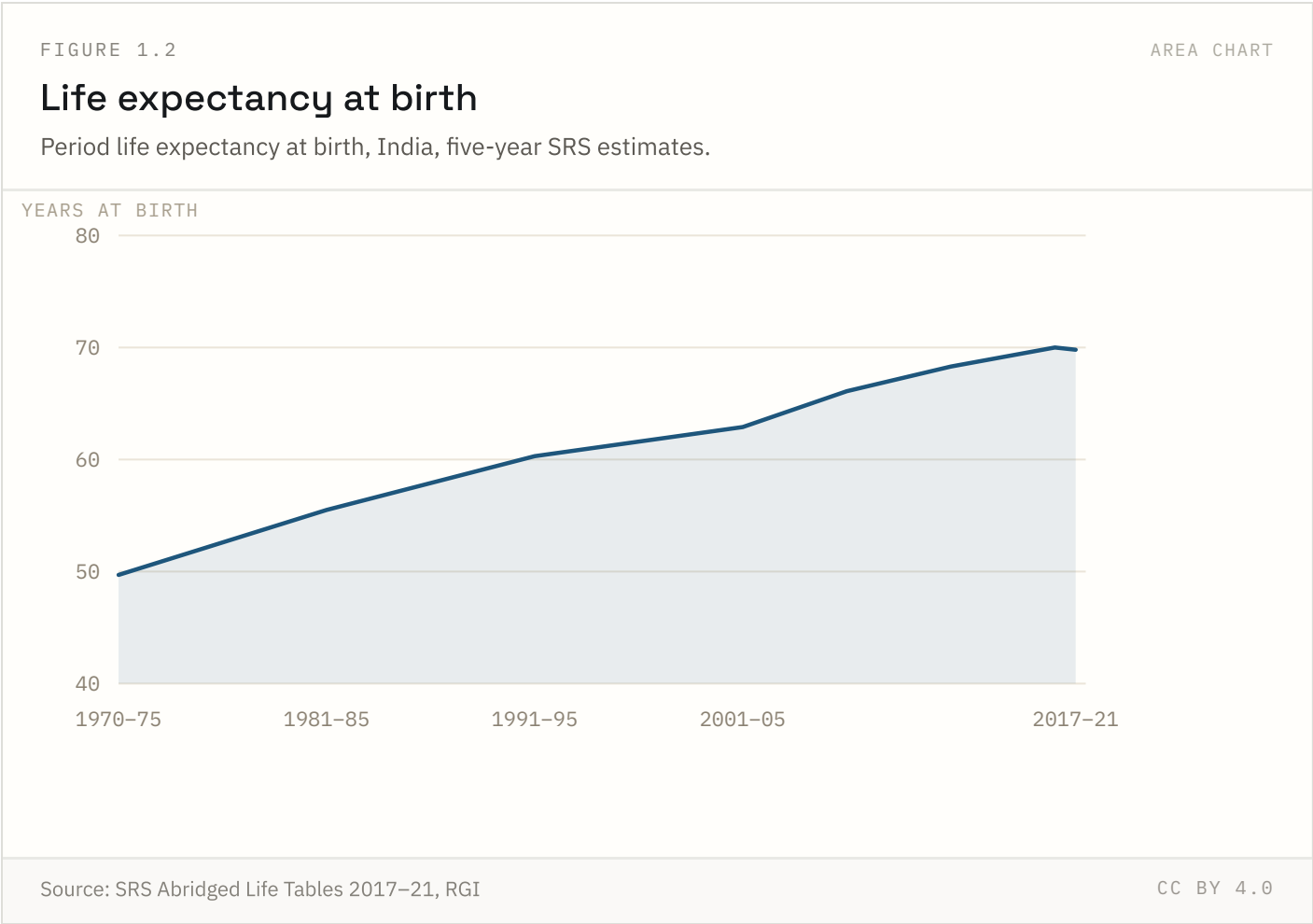
Population & demography

4 of 10 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

FIGURE 1.1 NATIONAL + STATE



The total fertility rate is the number of children a woman would bear if she experienced current age-specific fertility rates throughout her reproductive life. We splice decennial Census-based estimates to 1991 with the annual Sample Registration System thereafter; NFHS rounds are shown where they differ by more than 0.1.



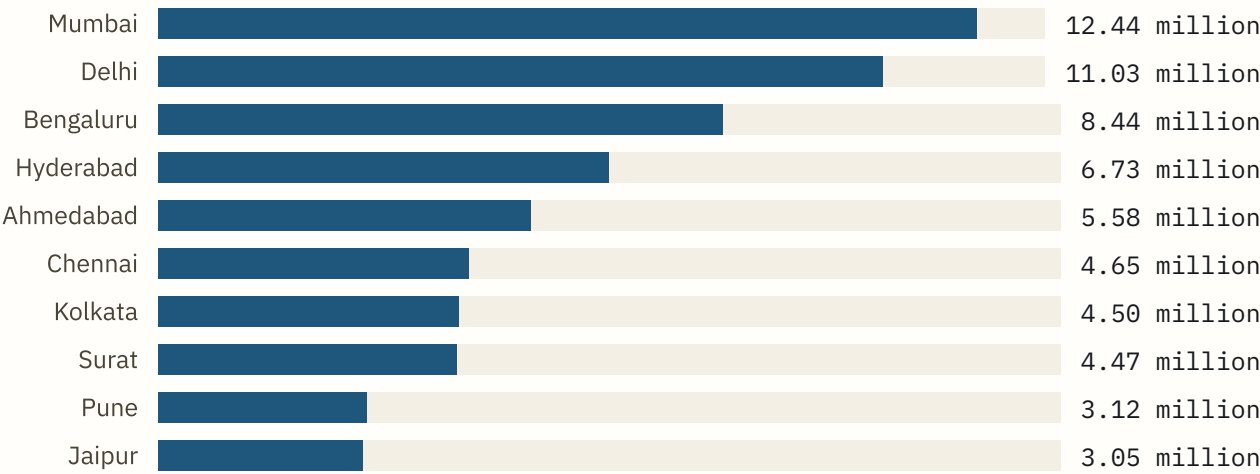
Period life expectancy at birth assumes a newborn experiences current mortality rates at every age for life. It is not a forecast of any individual cohort. The 2021 fall is real and reflects pandemic excess mortality; estimates of its size still vary across sources by several years.

FIGURE 1.3

RANKED BARS

Ten largest cities by population

Population within municipal limits (city proper), excluding the wider urban agglomeration.



SCALE 0 – 13.50 MILLION

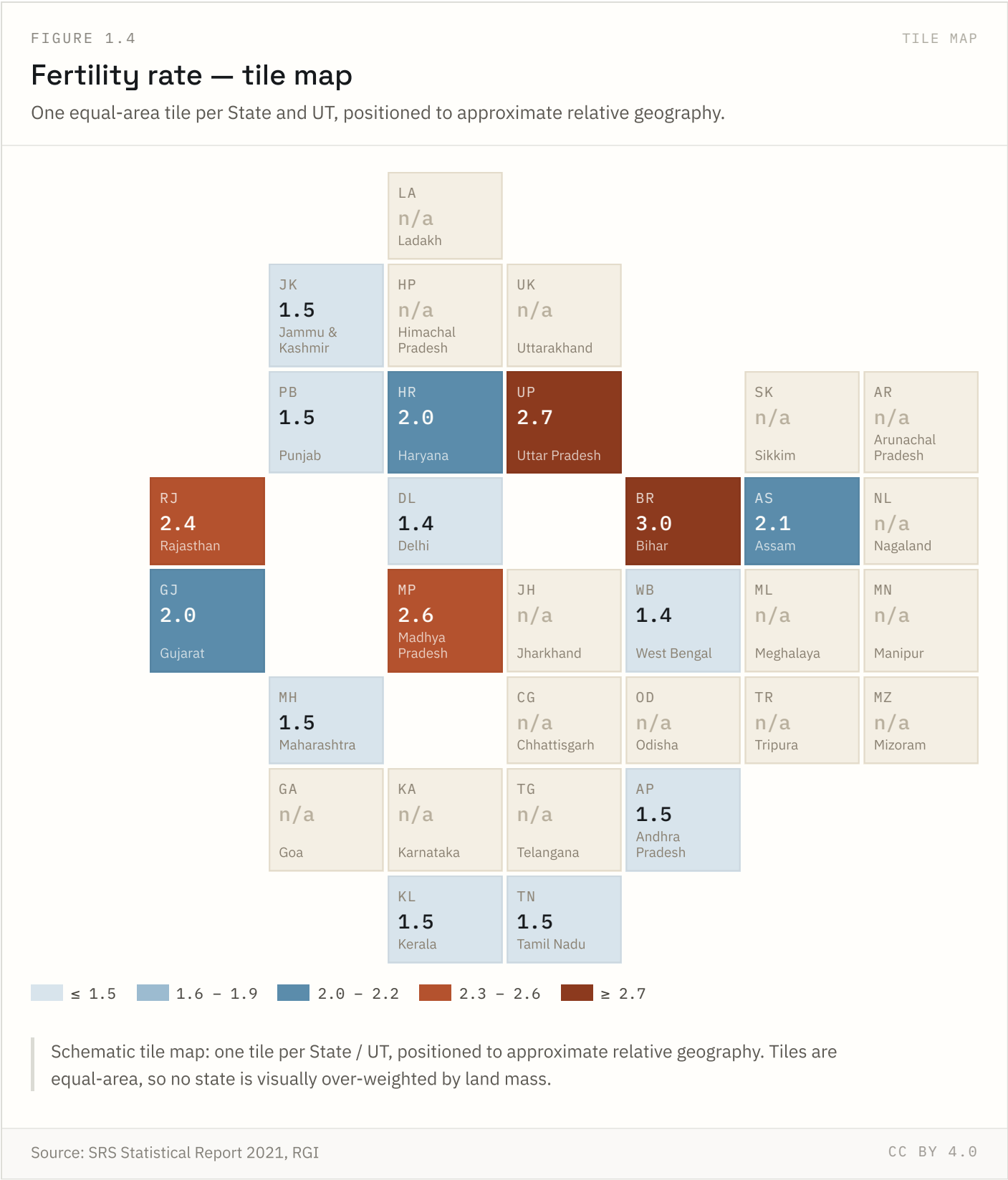
City-proper population, within municipal limits — smaller than the wider urban agglomeration. Delhi's urban agglomeration (16.3 million) is roughly 48% larger than the city figure shown here.

Source: Census of India 2011

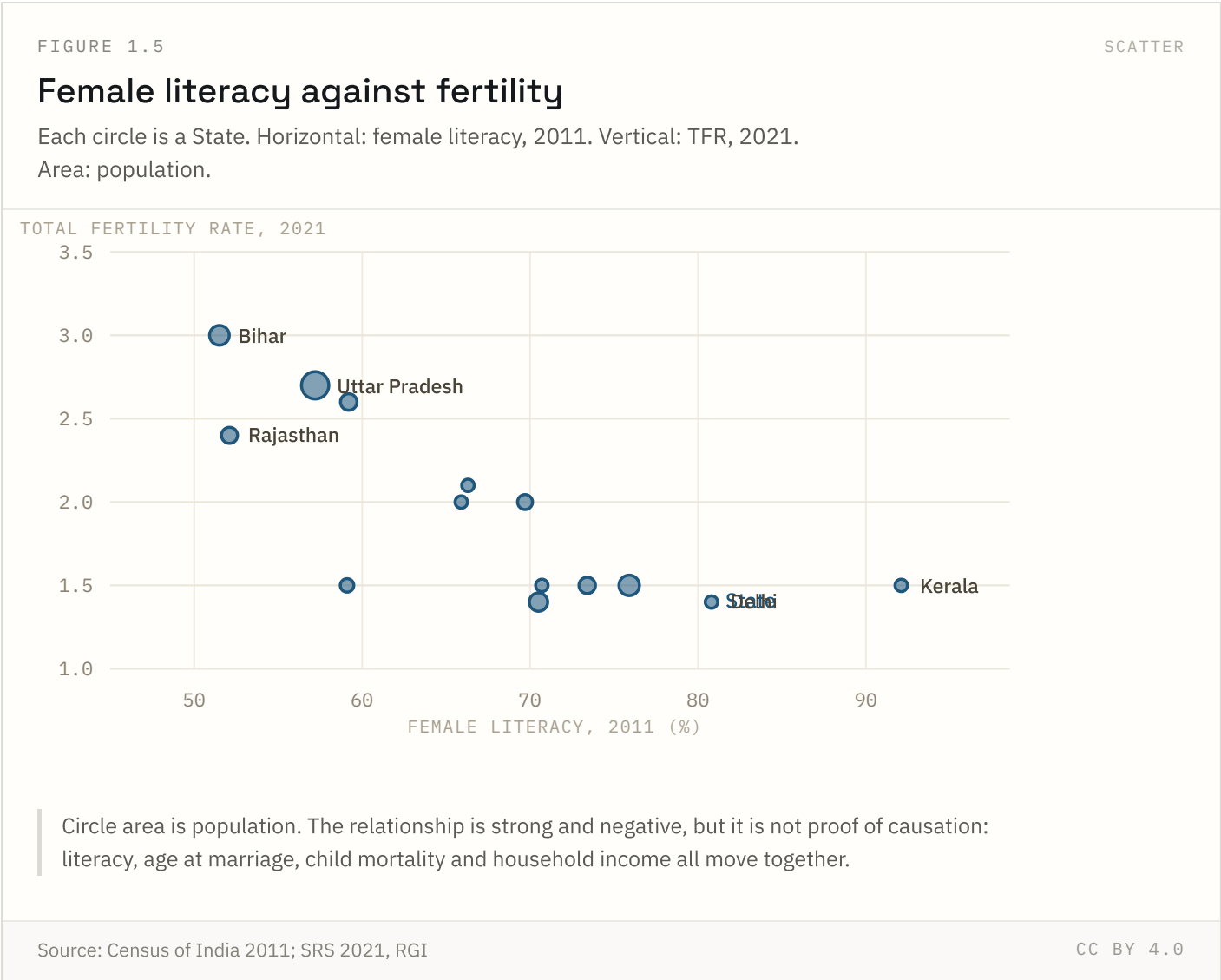
CC BY 4.0

City-proper population excludes adjoining outgrowths and satellite towns, so it understates real metropolitan size — Delhi's urban agglomeration (16.3 million) is roughly 48% larger than its city-proper figure. We use city-proper because it is the more consistently defined boundary across cities.

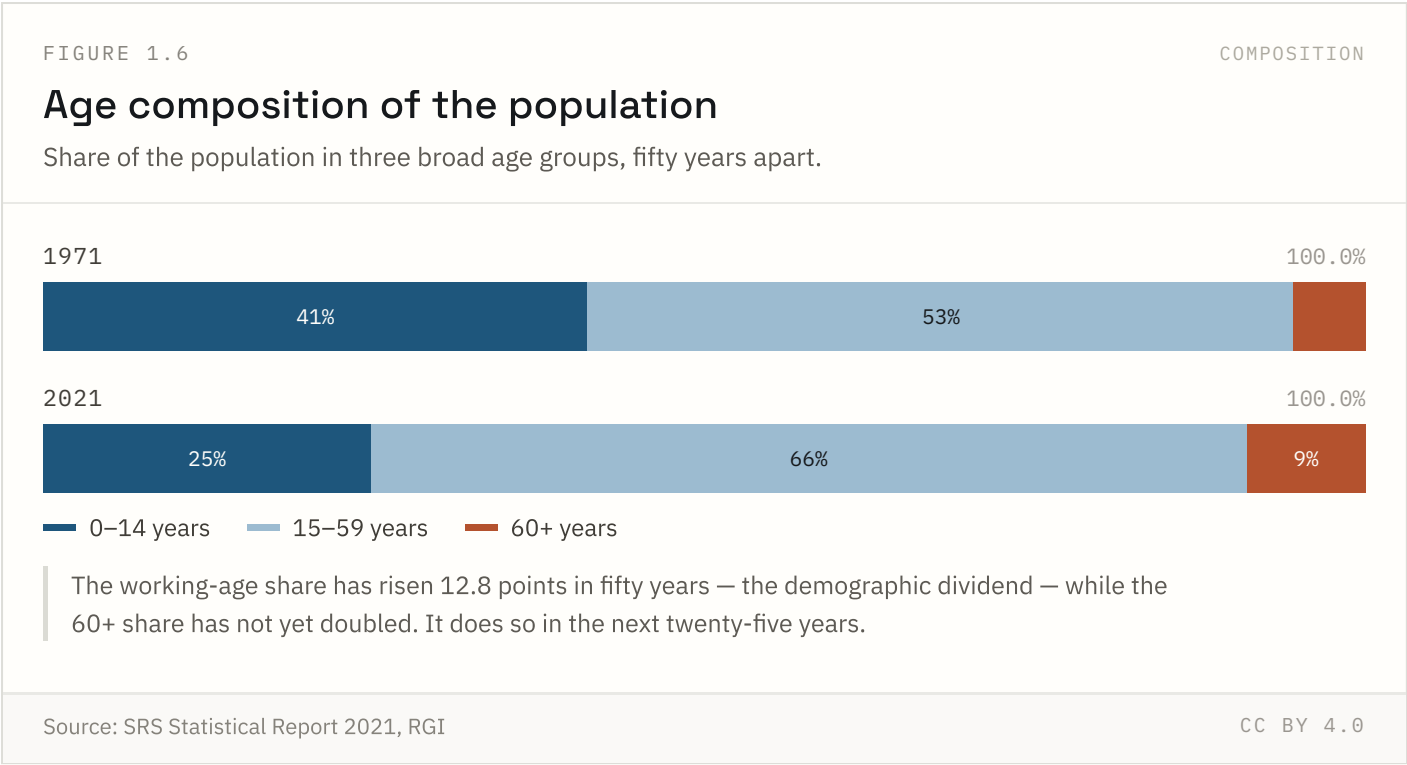
Source: Census of India 2011 Coverage: 2011 Updated: 16 Aug 2026



A tile map removes the visual bias of land area: Rajasthan does not shout louder than Kerala. Tiles marked n/a are States and UTs for which the SRS 2021 report does not publish a separate TFR estimate.

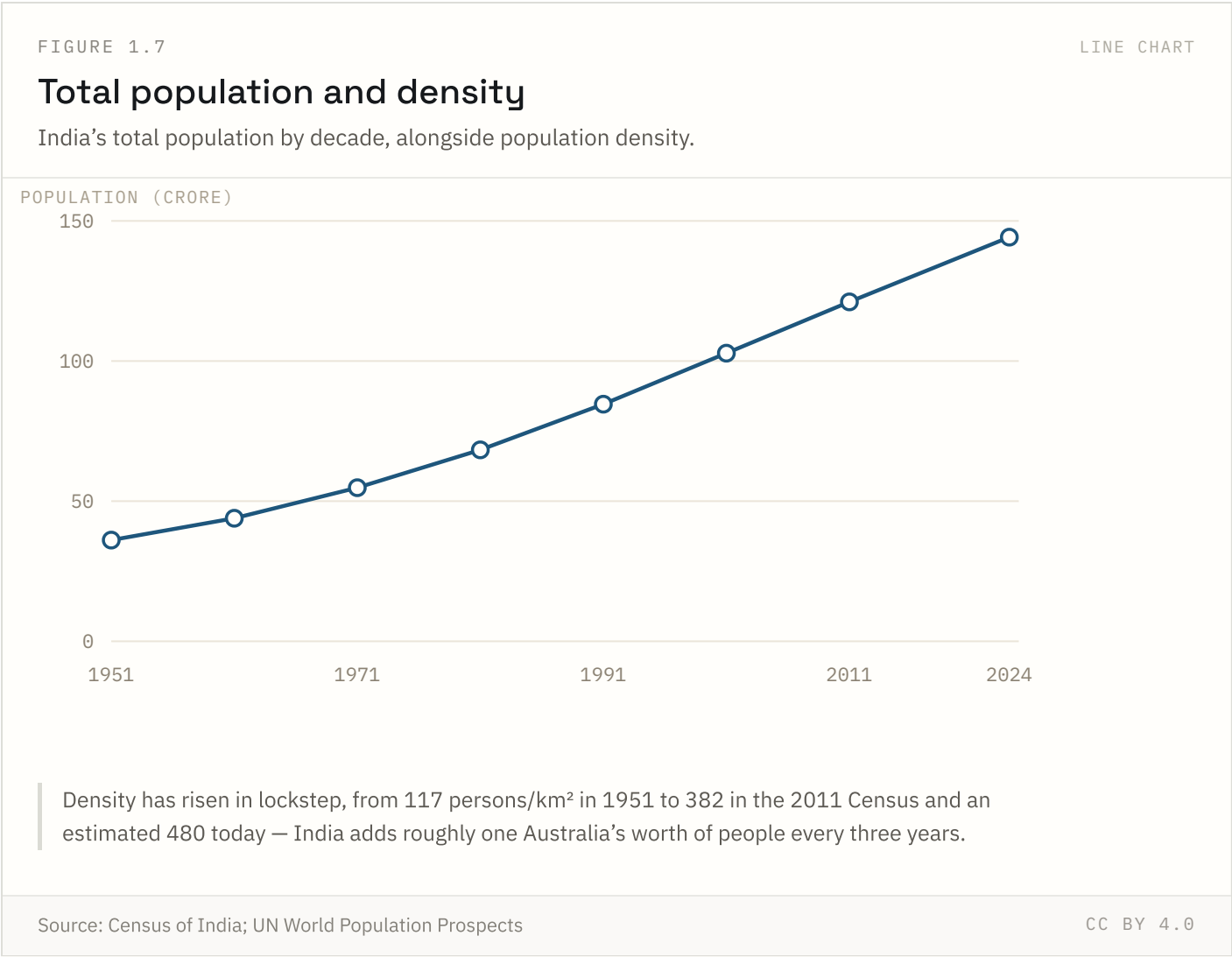


The negative relationship is strong across States, but it is not evidence of causation on its own — literacy, age at marriage, child mortality and household income all move together. Read it as a description of the fertility map, not a mechanism.



The 0–14 share fell from 41.2% to 24.8% between 1971 and 2021 while the working-age share rose to 66.2%. That gap is the demographic dividend; it closes as the 60+ share, now 9.0%, roughly doubles by 2050.

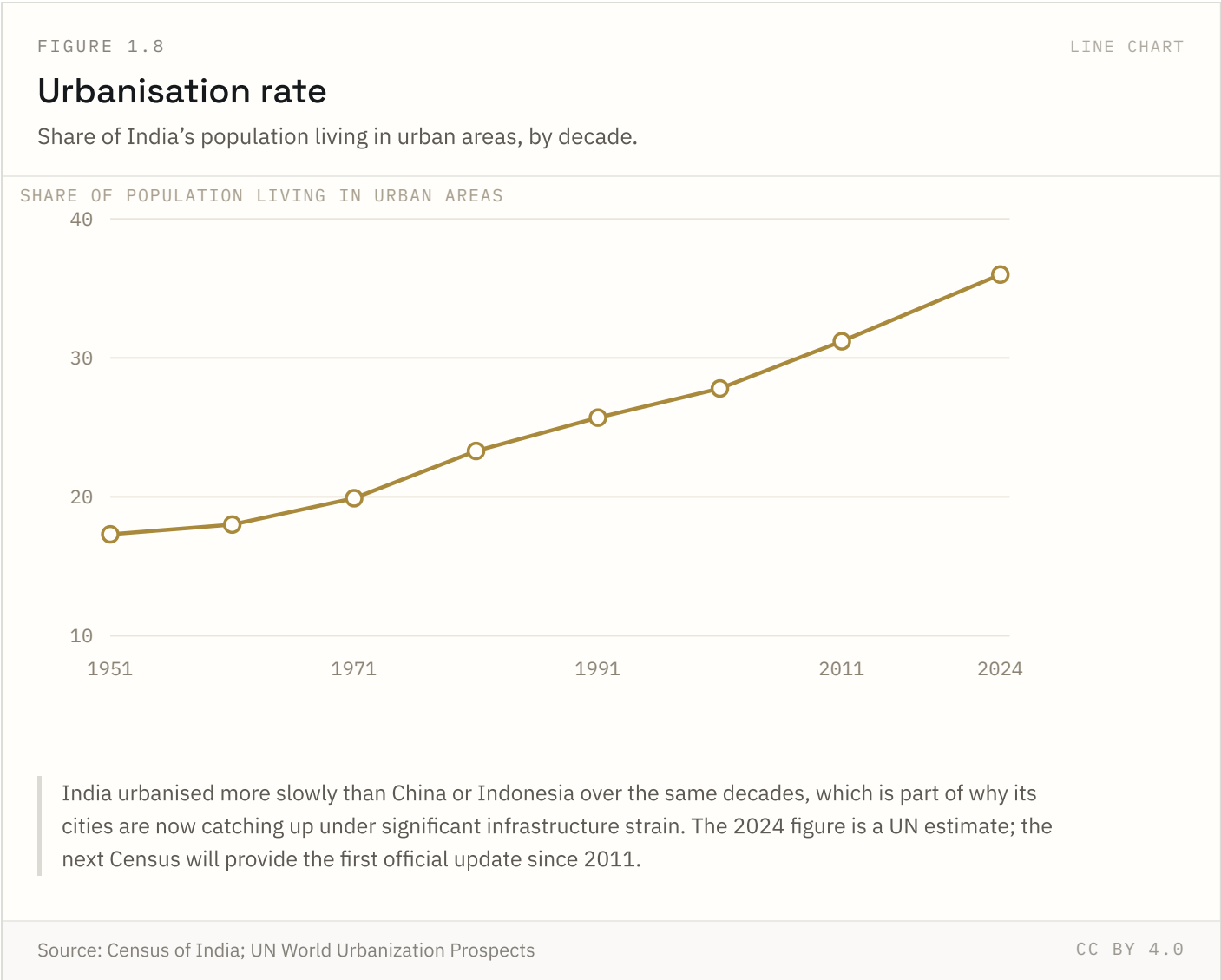
FIGURE 1.7 NATIONAL ONLY



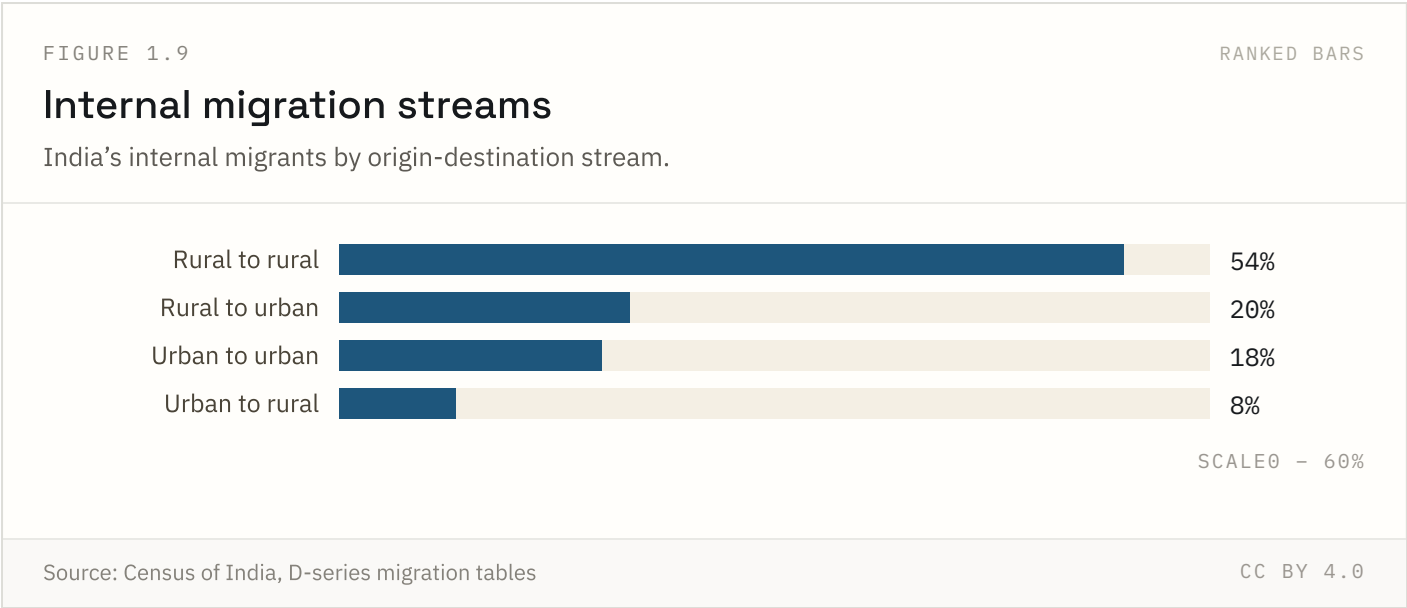
India crossed 1 billion people around 2000 and an estimated 1.44 billion by 2024, having overtaken China as the world's most populous country in 2023. Density figures assume a fixed land area, so they track population growth almost exactly.

Source: Census of India; UN World Population Prospects Coverage: 1951–2024 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

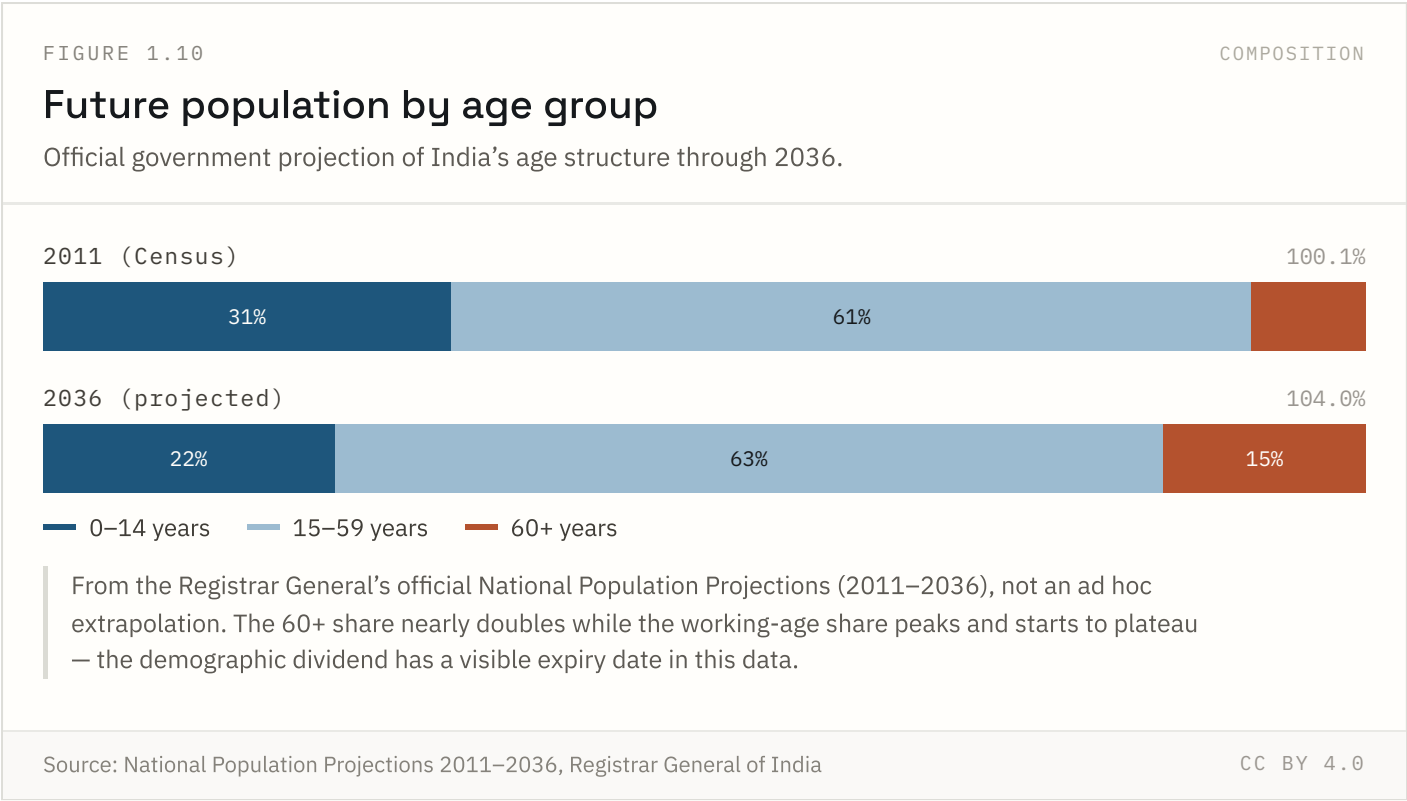
FIGURE 1.8 NATIONAL ONLY



India’s urbanisation has been notably gradual compared to East Asian peers — a mixed blessing that avoided some of the informal-settlement crises seen elsewhere, but also means the next wave of urban growth, now underway, is arriving on infrastructure built for a smaller urban population.



Rural-to-rural migration, mostly marriage-related moves by women, is the largest stream by volume — rural-to-urban labour migration, the stream most associated with India’s growth story, is actually the second largest, not the biggest.



This is RGI's own published projection, not an extrapolation built for this site. It shows the demographic dividend has a visible expiry date: the working-age share is projected to plateau around the mid-2030s as the 60+ share nearly doubles from its 2011 level.

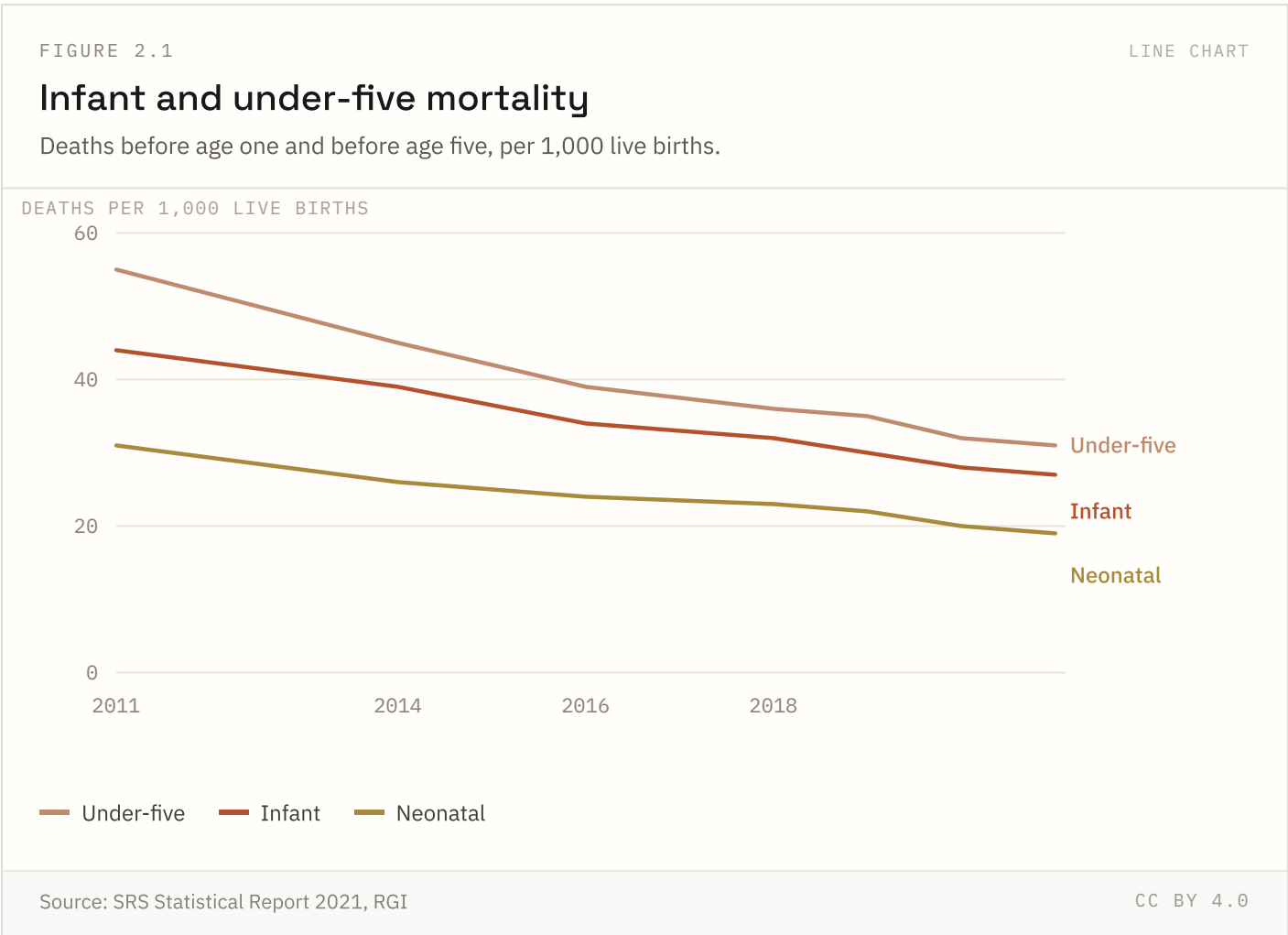
Source: National Population Projections 2011–2036, Registrar General of India

Coverage: 2011 to 2036 (projected) Updated: 18 Aug 2026

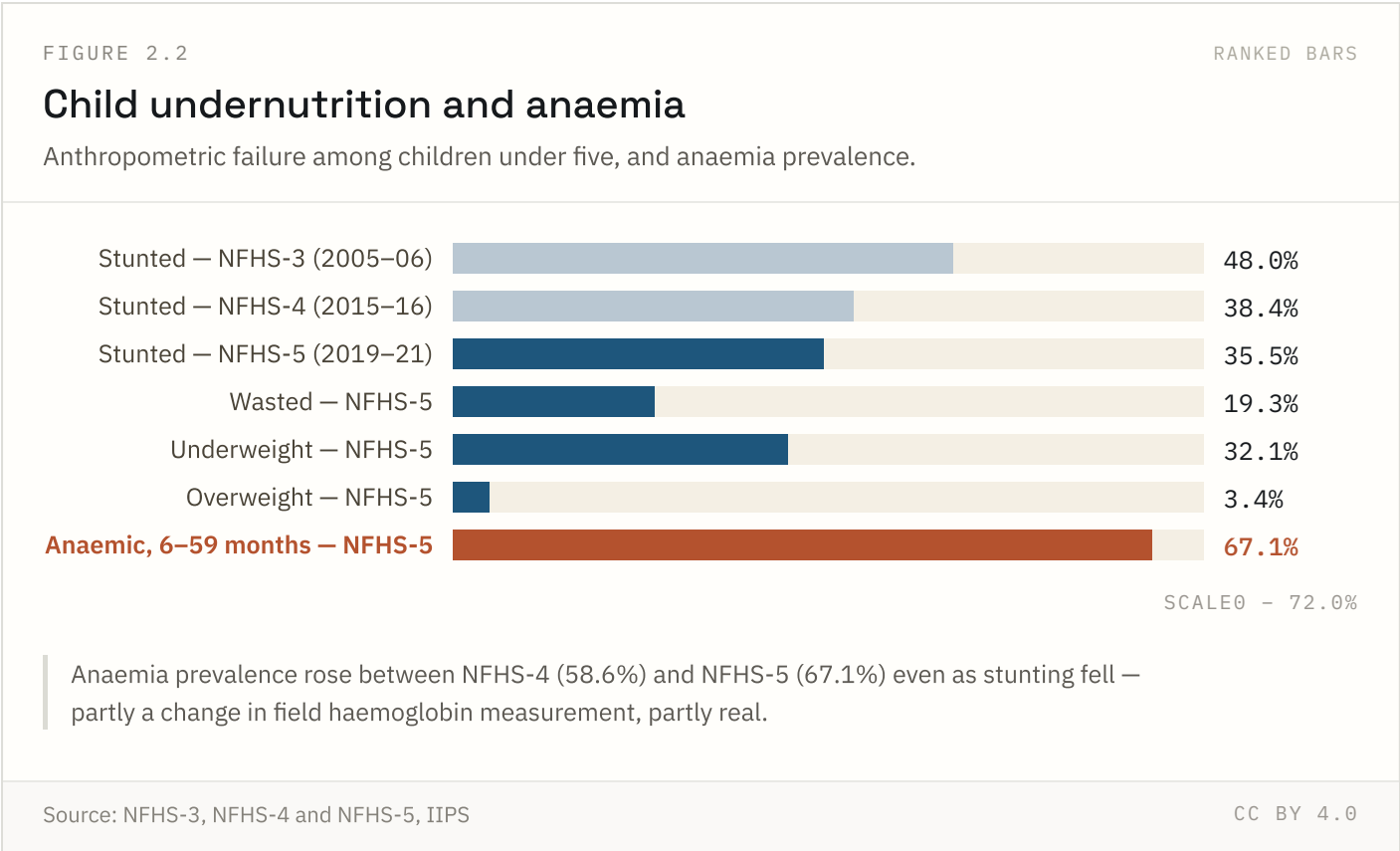
Health & nutrition

3 of 4 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

FIGURE 2.1 NATIONAL + STATE

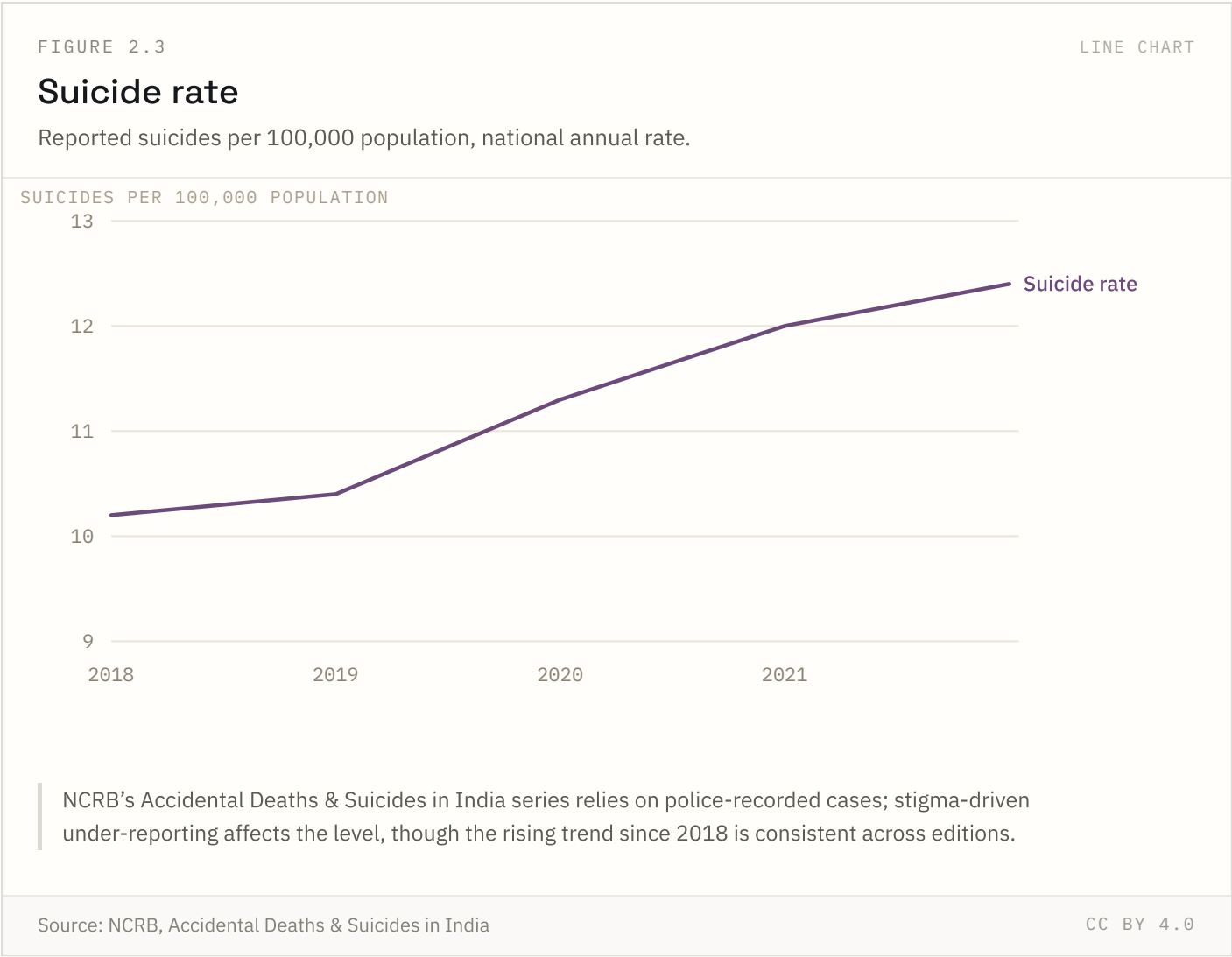


India accounted for roughly a fifth of global under-five deaths in 2022, down from a third in 1990. The decline is steepest in states that expanded institutional delivery fastest after 2005.



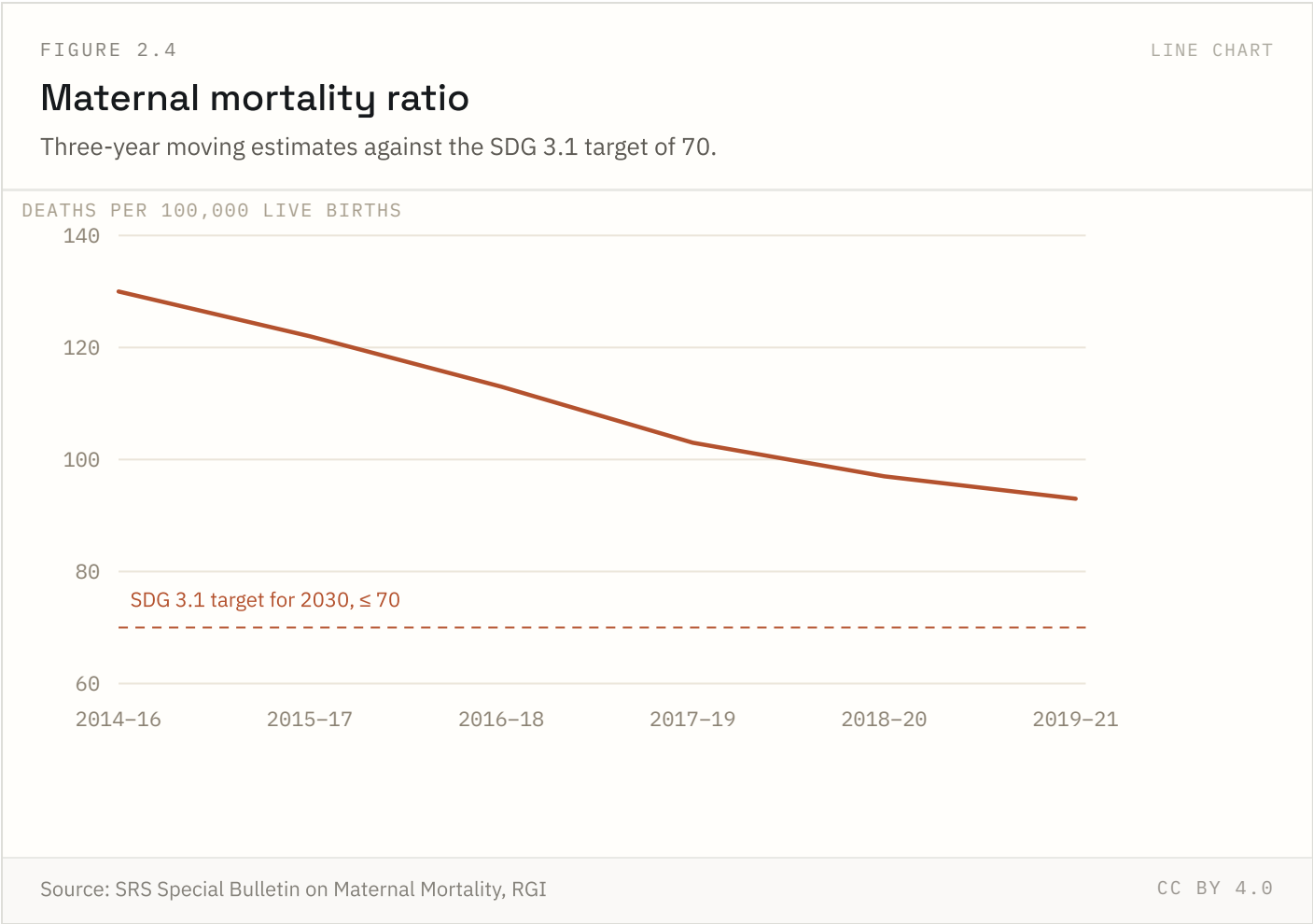
Stunting (low height-for-age) reflects chronic undernutrition; wasting (low weight-for-height) reflects acute deficits. Anaemia prevalence rose between NFHS-4 and NFHS-5 even as stunting fell — partly a measurement change, partly real.

FIGURE 2.3 NATIONAL ONLY



The rate has risen every year since 2018. NCRB figures are police-recorded cases; stigma and, until 2017, the criminal status of attempted suicide are known sources of under-reporting, so levels are likely understated even where the trend is real.

Source: NCRB, Accidental Deaths & Suicides in India Coverage: 2018–2022 Updated: 18 Aug 2026



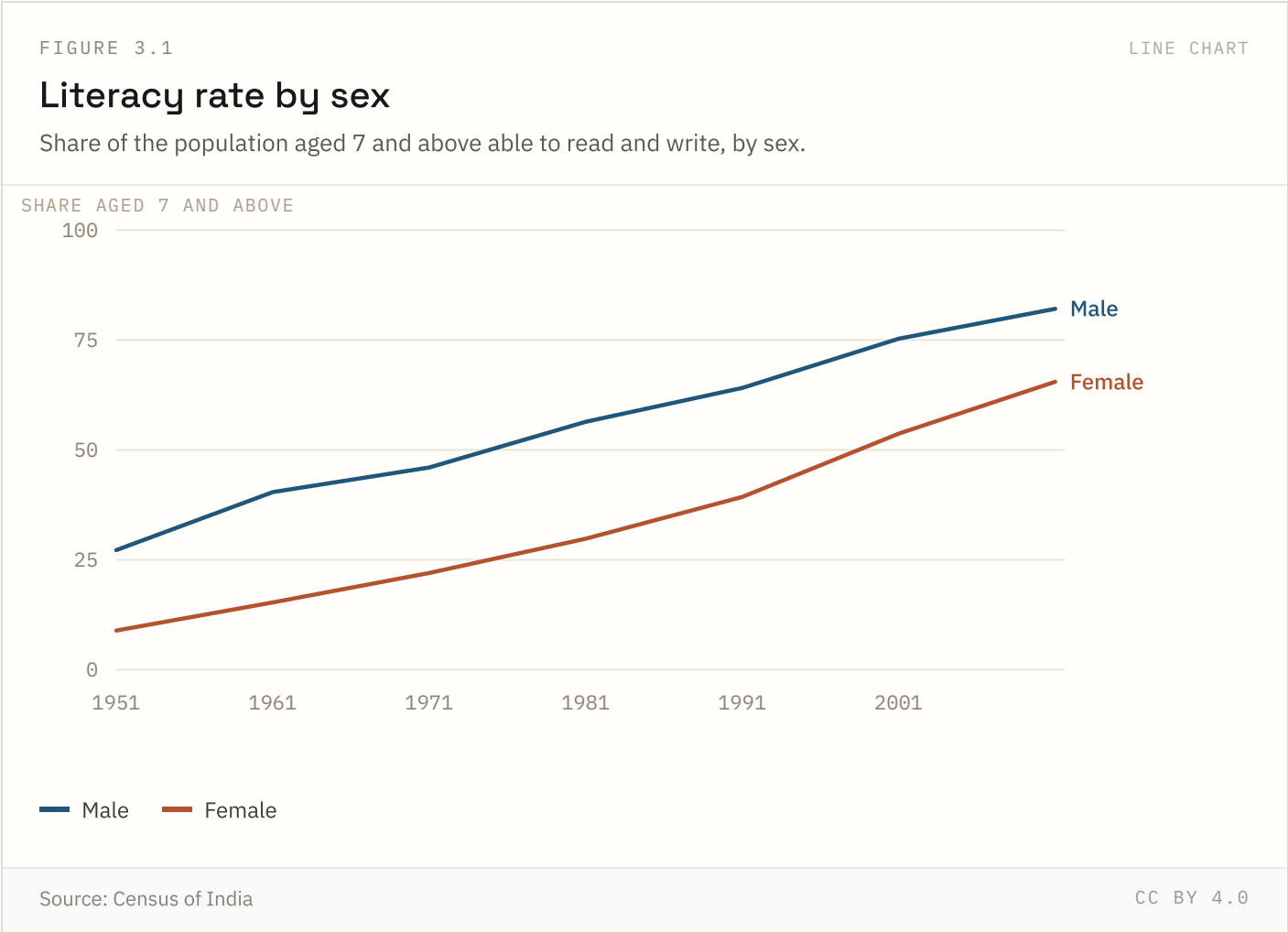
MMR fell from 130 in 2014–16 to 93 in 2019–21. Eight States have already met the SDG target; Assam, Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh and Bihar remain furthest from it.

Source: SRS Special Bulletin on Maternal Mortality, RGI Coverage: 2014–16 to 2019–21 Updated: 02 Jun 2026

Education & literacy

3 of 4 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

FIGURE 3.1 NATIONAL + STATE



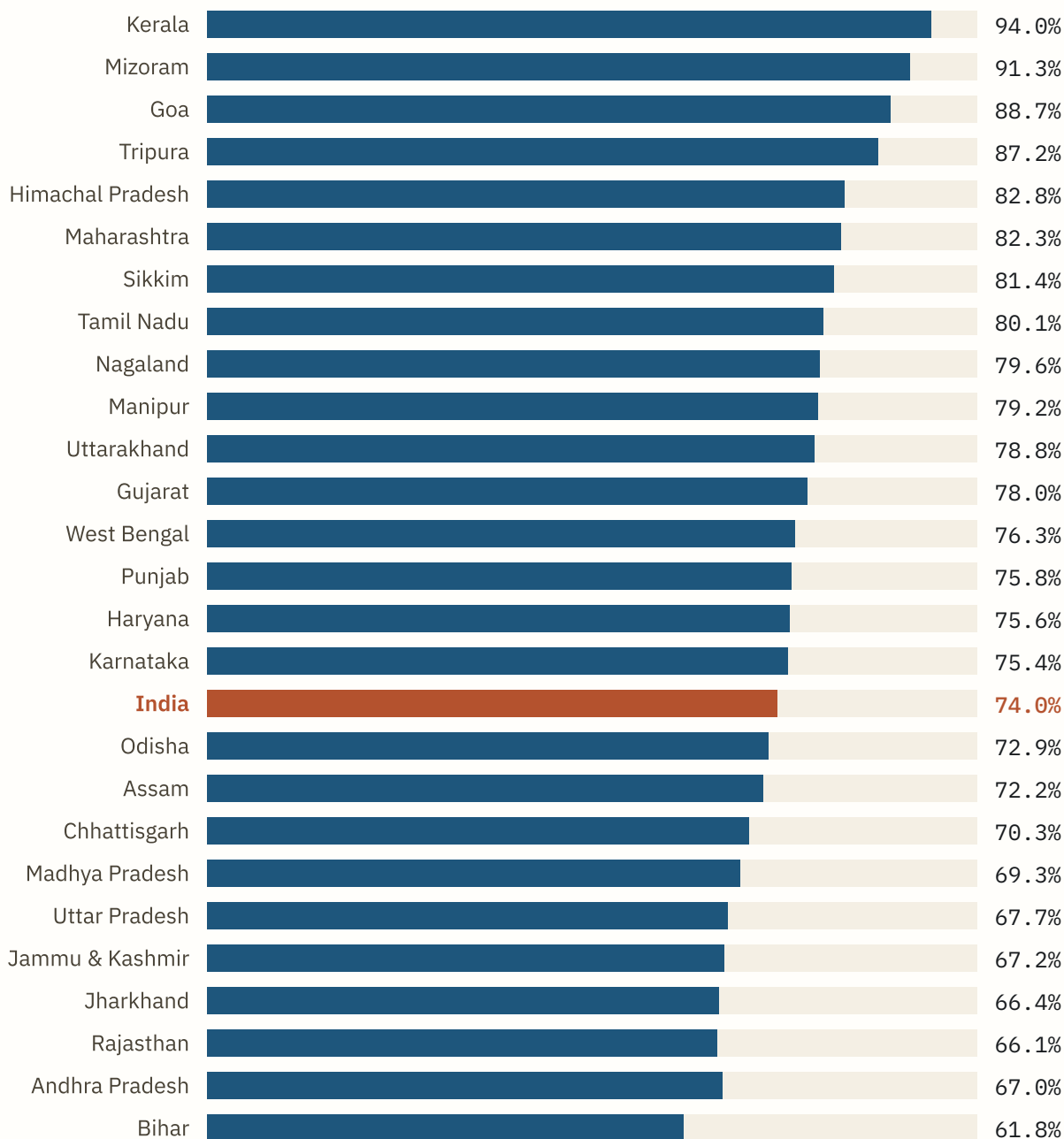
The Census definition — able to read and write with understanding in any language — is self-reported and generous. Survey-based functional literacy measures run 8–14 points lower. The series ends in 2011 because the 2021 Census was postponed.

FIGURE 3.2

RANKED BARS

Literacy rate by state

Census 2011 literacy rates. The national figure is shown in rust.



SCALE 0 - 100.0%

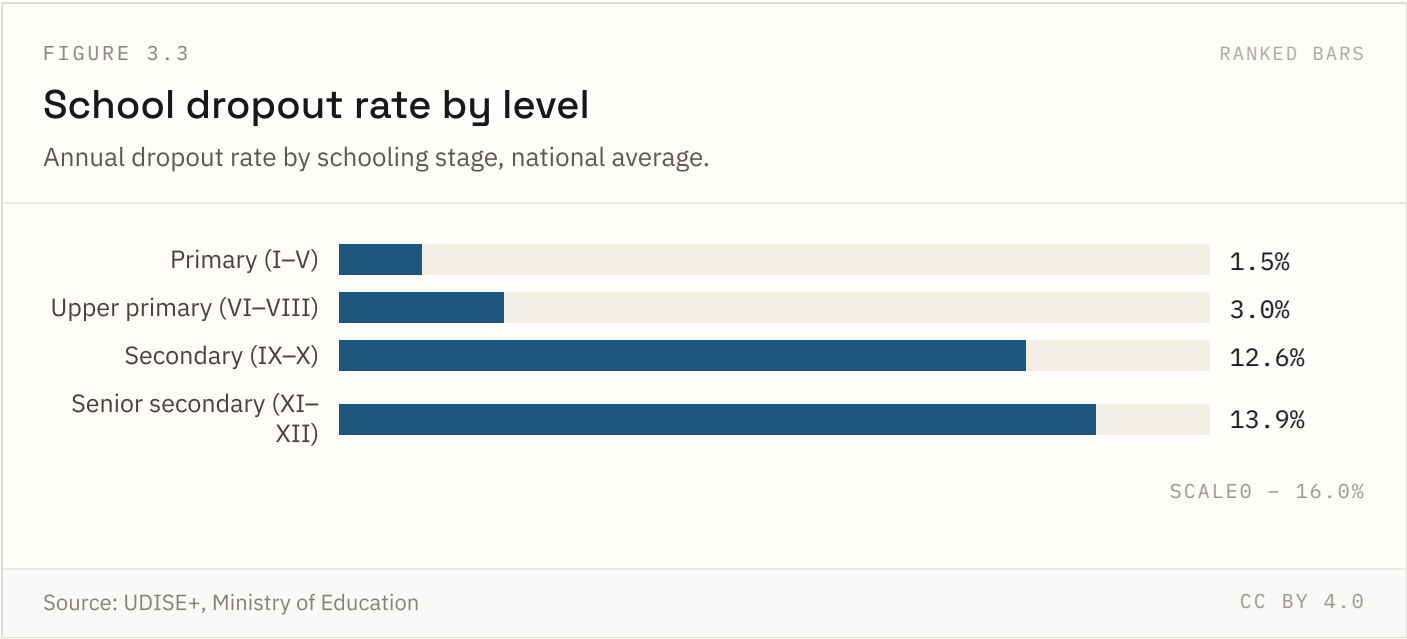
Source: Census of India 2011

CC BY 4.0

Kerala has led every Census round since 1951. The bottom of the ranking has been more stable than the top: Bihar has been last or second-last in every round since 1961.

Highest: **Kerala** at 94.0%. Lowest: **Bihar** at 61.8%.

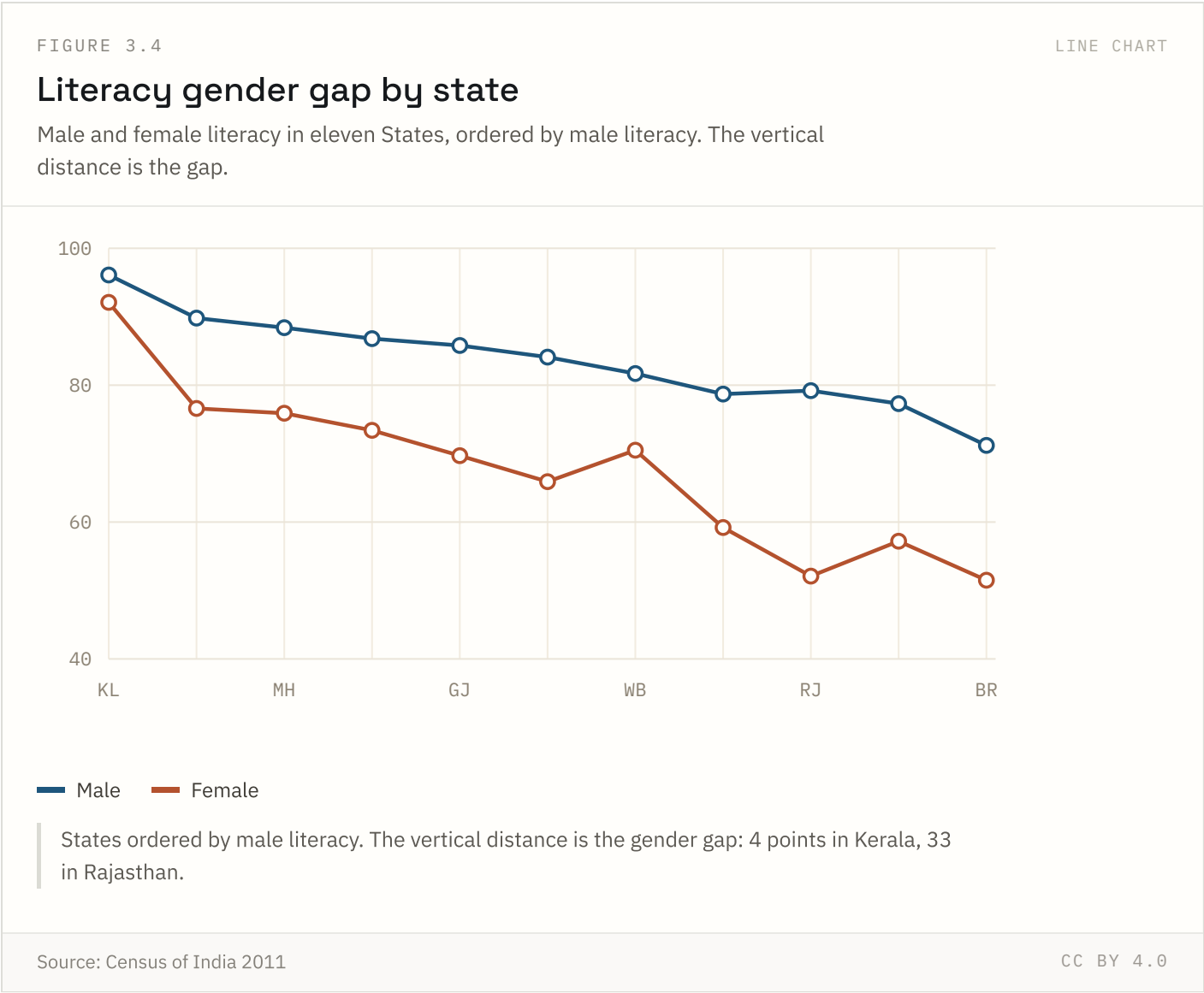
FIGURE 3.3 NATIONAL ONLY



Dropout is heavily concentrated at the secondary stage, roughly the age children are pulled into work or, for girls in some states, marriage. Primary-stage dropout is now low nationally, though state variation is much wider than the national figure suggests.

Source: UDISE+, Ministry of Education Coverage: 2021-22 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

FIGURE 3.4 NATIONAL + STATE

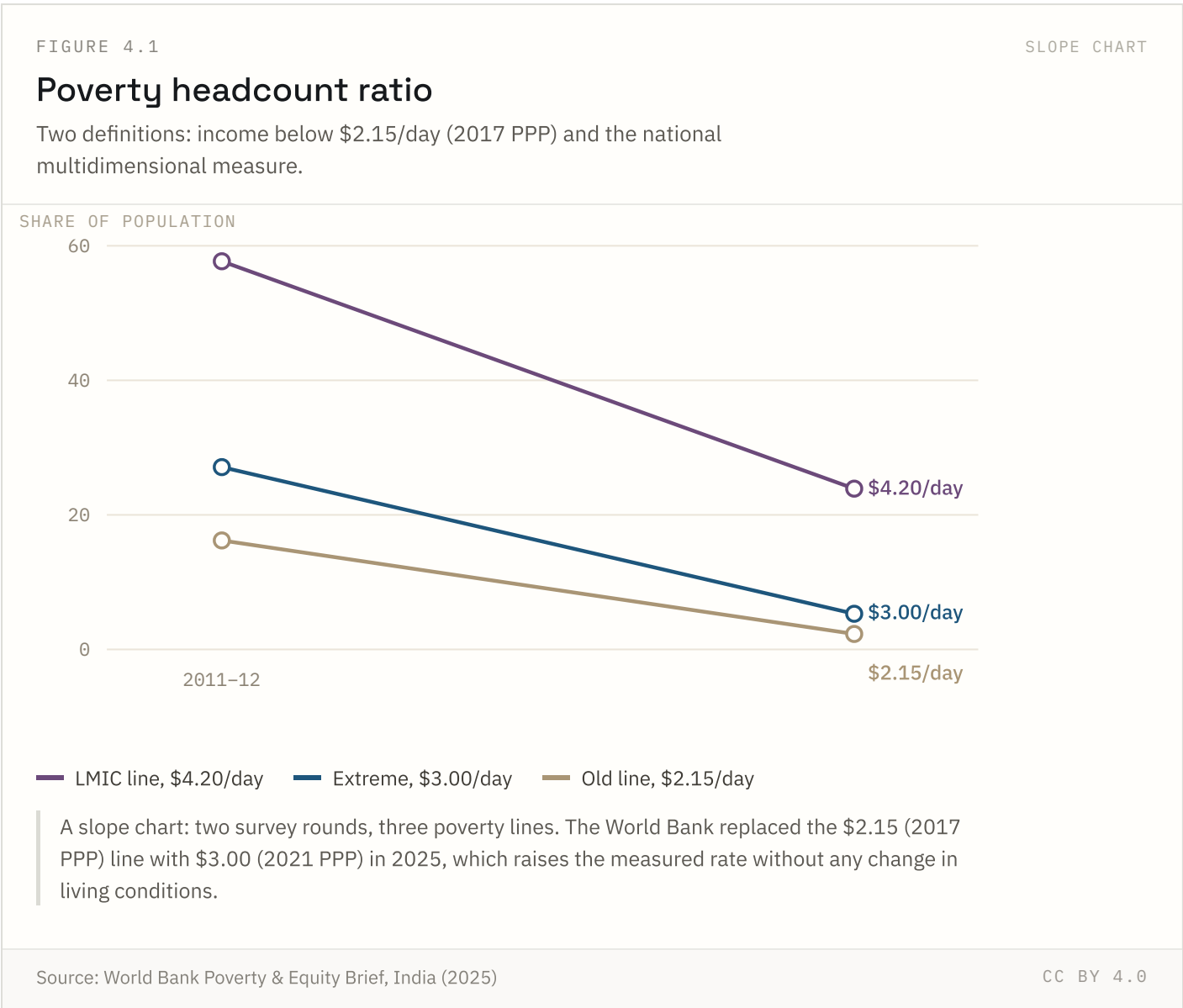


The gap is 4 points in Kerala and 33 in Rajasthan. States with high male literacy do not automatically have small gaps: West Bengal and Madhya Pradesh have similar male rates and very different female ones.

Poverty & incomes

3 of 7 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

FIGURE 4.1 NATIONAL + STATE



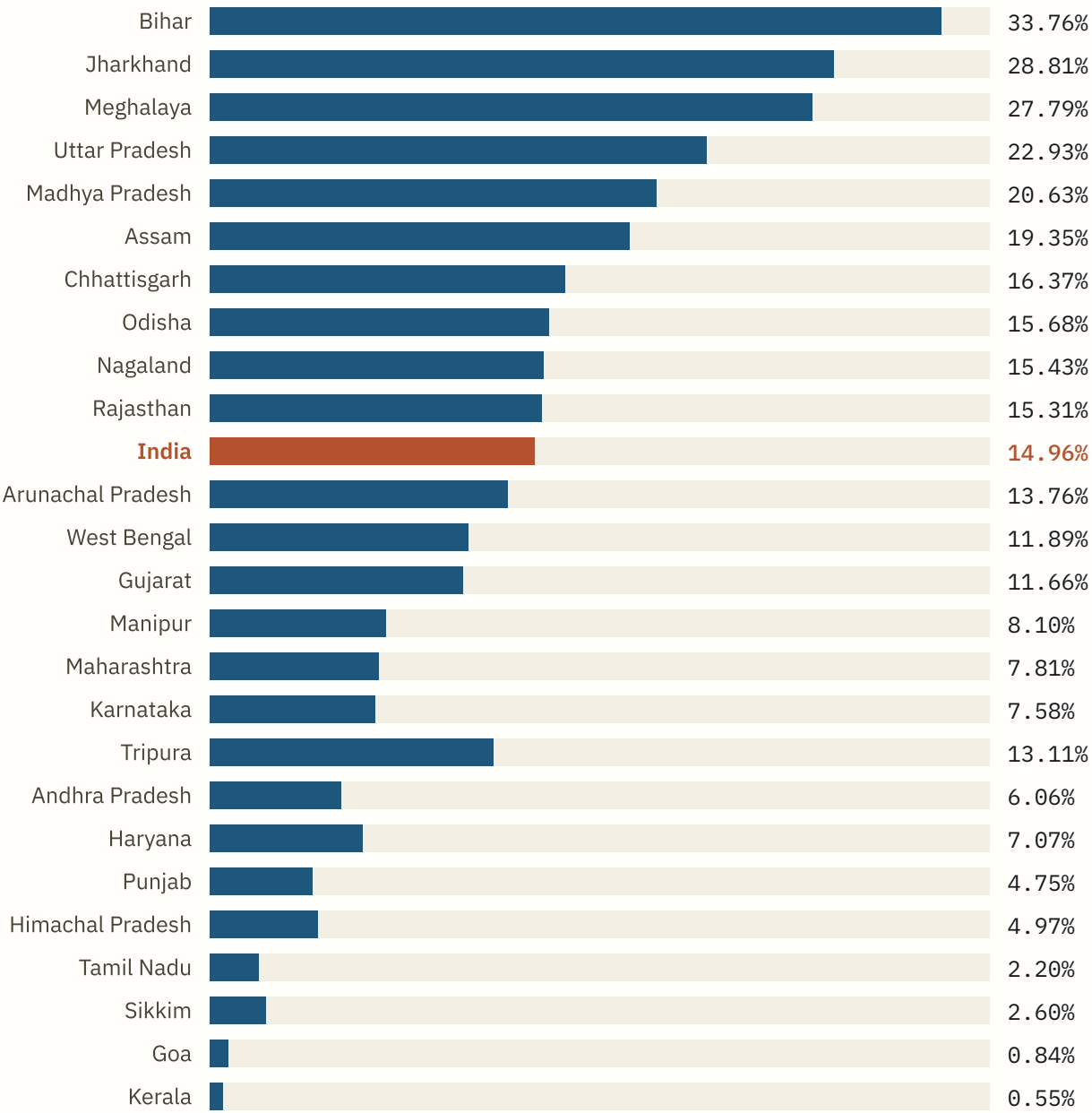
Income poverty and multidimensional poverty answer different questions. The MPI counts deprivations in nutrition, schooling, sanitation, fuel, housing and assets; a household can escape the income line while remaining multidimensionally poor, and often does.

FIGURE 4.2

RANKED BARS

Multidimensional poverty by state

Share of the population identified as multidimensionally poor, NFHS-5 round.



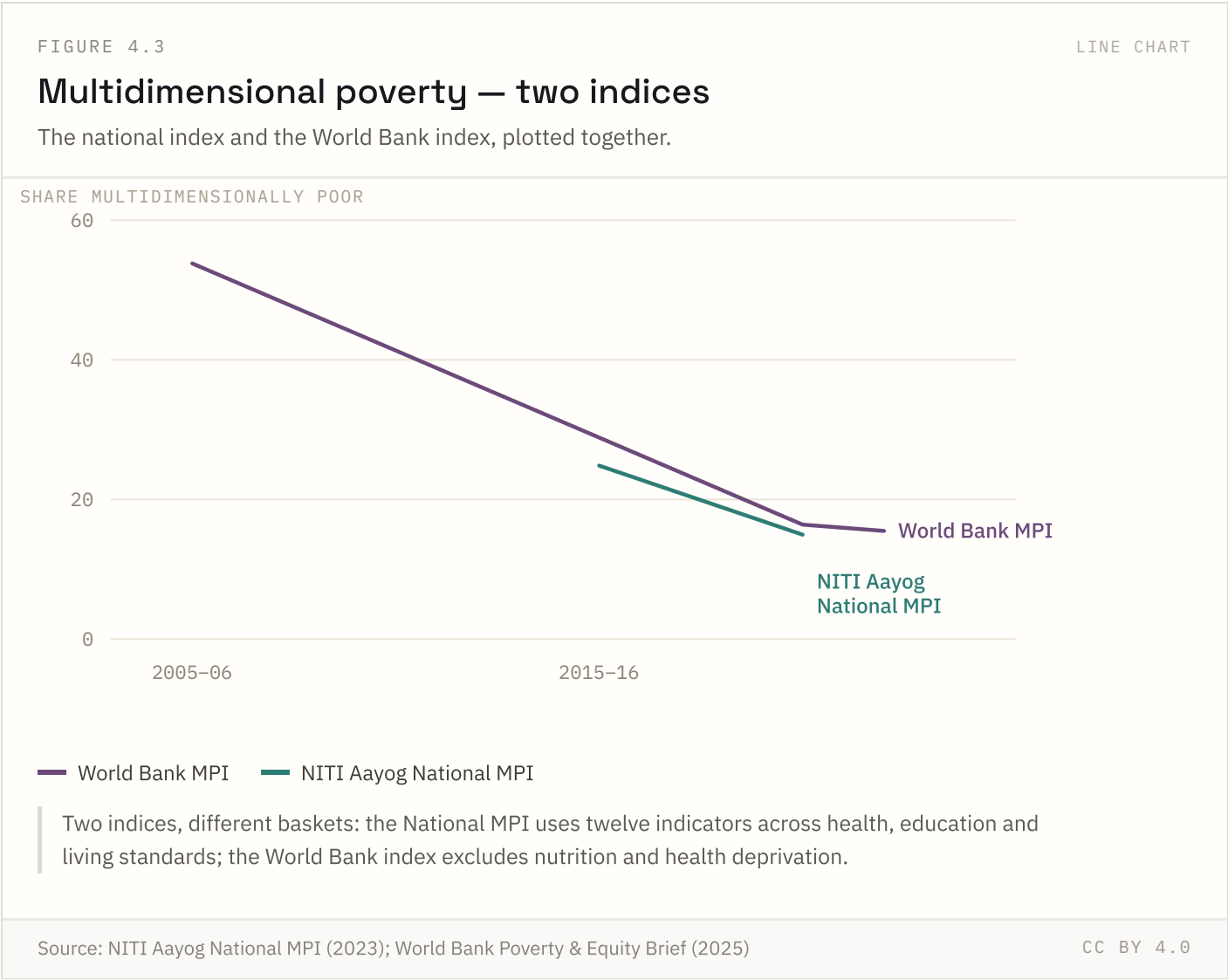
SCALE 0 - 36.00%

Source: NITI Aayog National MPI – A Progress Review 2023

CC BY 4.0

The National MPI uses twelve indicators across health, education and living standards. Bihar, Jharkhand and Uttar Pradesh together account for roughly half of India’s multidimensionally poor population.

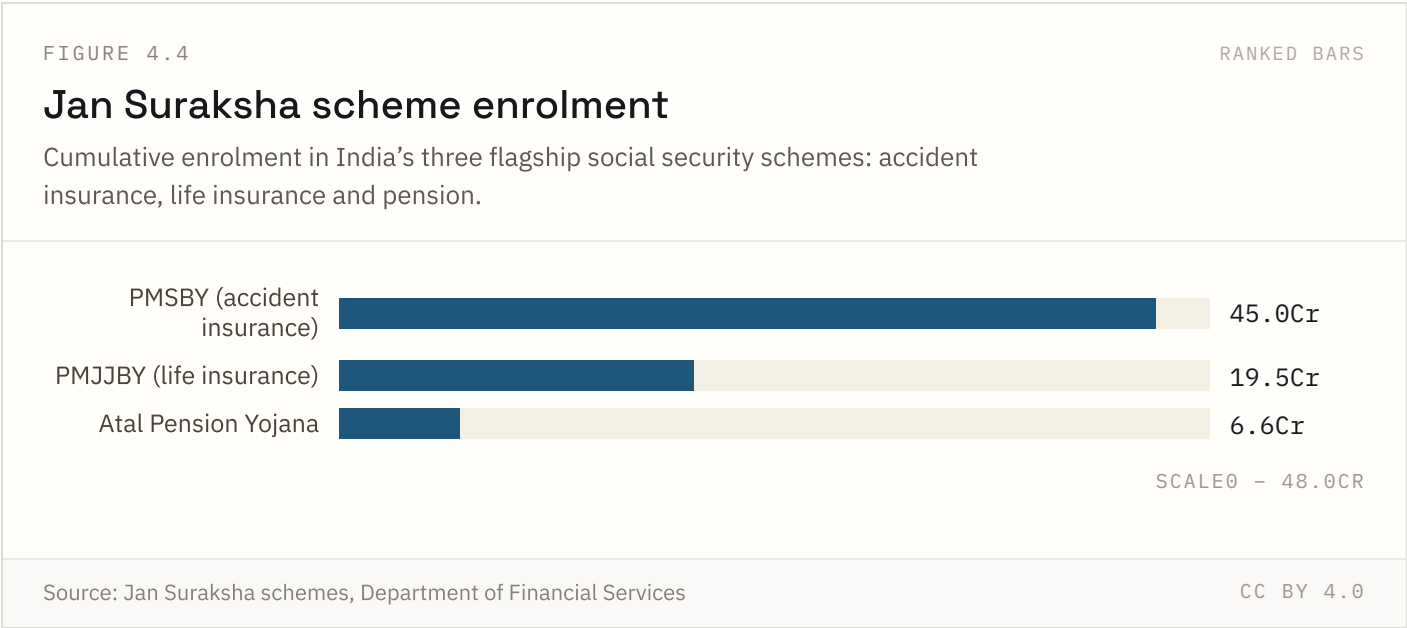
Highest: **Bihar** at 33.76%. Lowest: **Kerala** at 0.55%.



The two indices use different baskets — the National MPI counts twelve indicators including nutrition and maternal health, the World Bank version excludes them — so they should be read as bounds rather than as competing estimates of one quantity.

Source: NITI Aayog National MPI (2023); World Bank Poverty & Equity Brief (2025) Coverage: 2005-06 to 2022-23

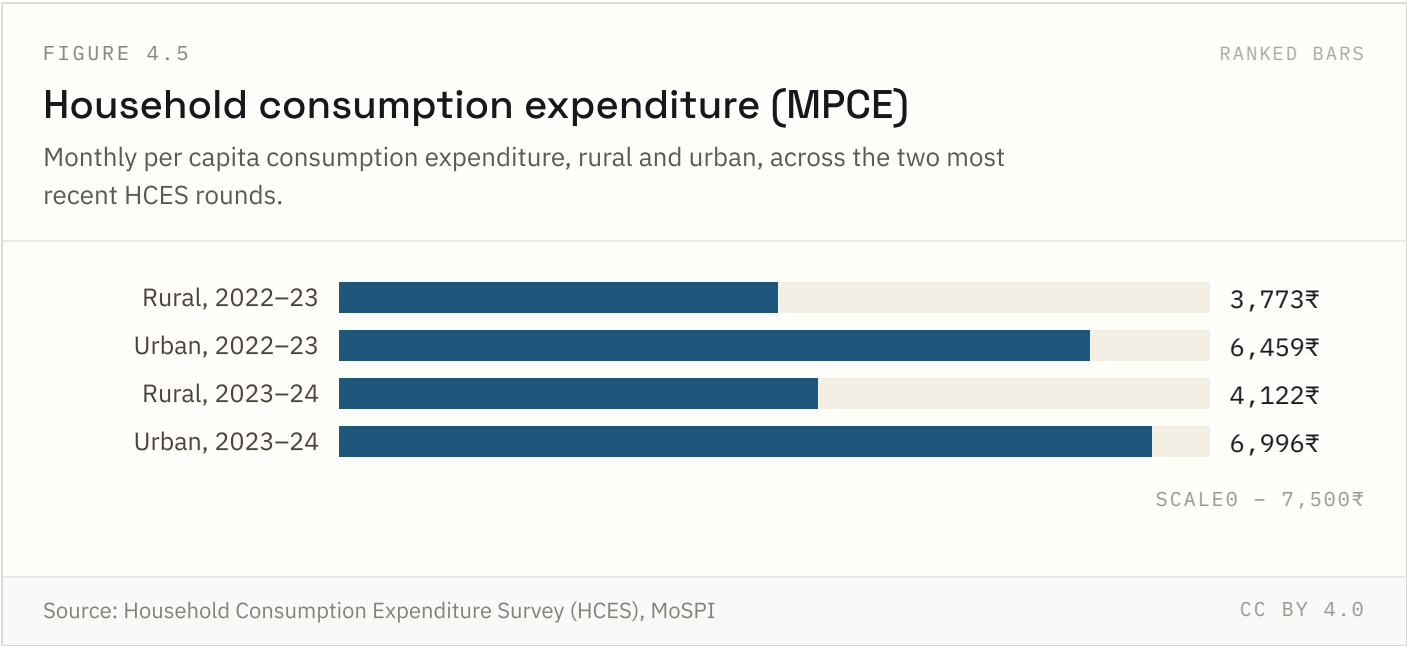
Updated: 24 Jul 2026



PMSBY’s low annual premium (₹20) drives far higher enrolment than the pension scheme, which requires a recurring contribution. Enrolment counts include lapsed and inactive accounts in most published figures, so active coverage is somewhat lower than these cumulative totals suggest.

Source: Jan Suraksha schemes, Department of Financial Services Coverage: Cumulative to 2024

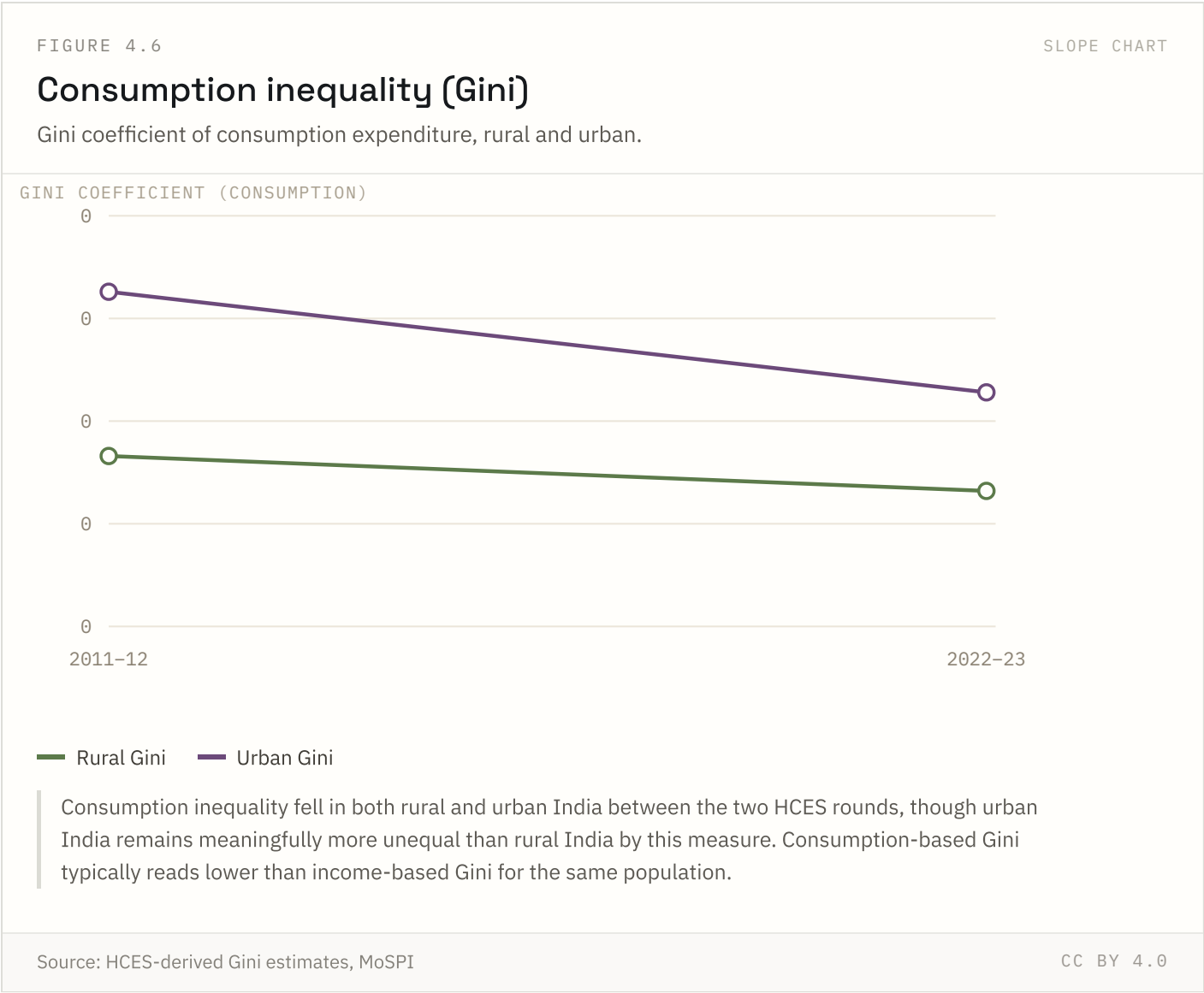
Updated: 18 Aug 2026



MPCE is the bridge between GDP growth and how households actually live — it is the base data used to estimate poverty and inequality. The urban-rural gap (roughly 70%) has narrowed only slightly across the two rounds.

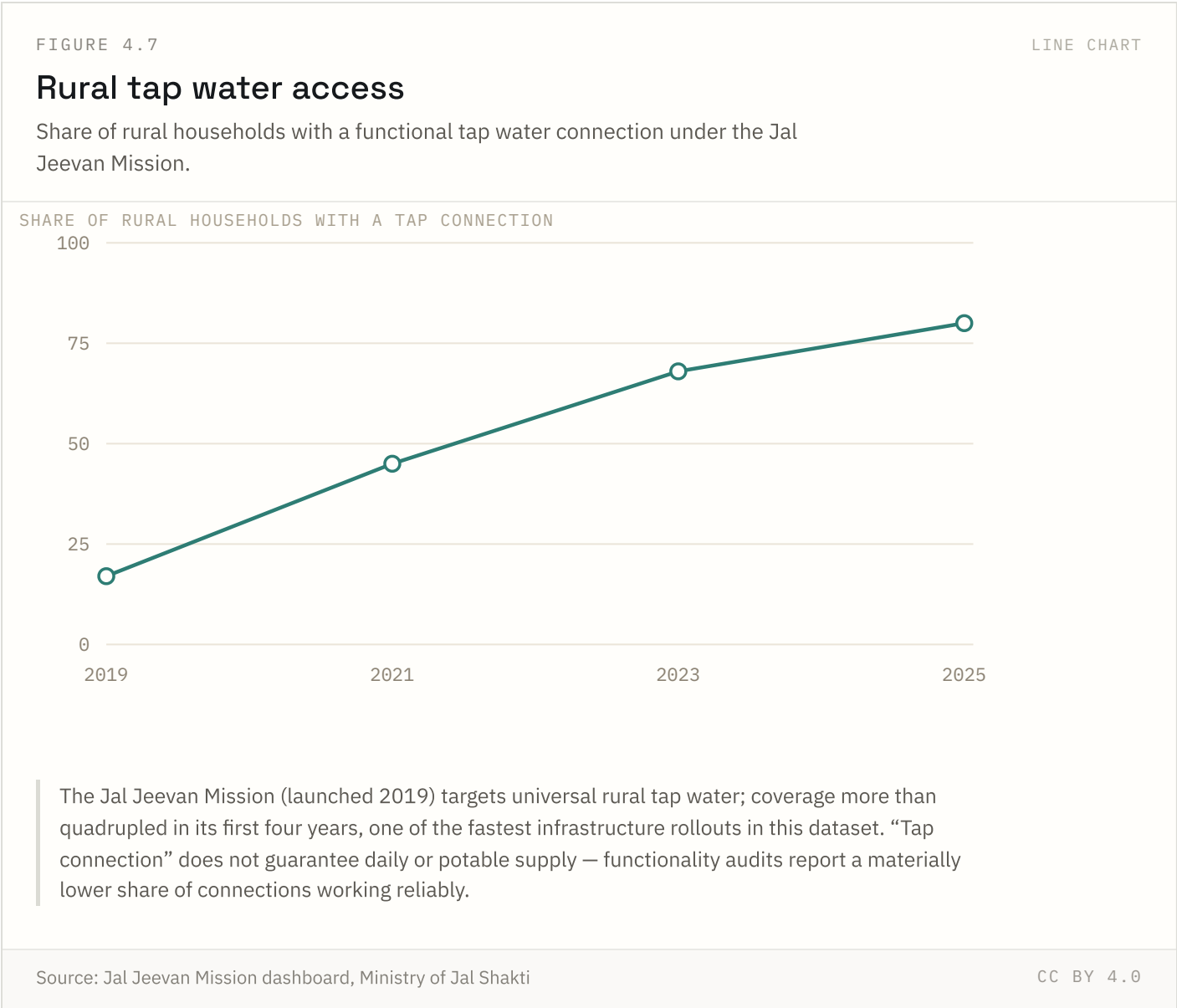
Source: Household Consumption Expenditure Survey (HCES), MoSPI Coverage: 2022–23 to 2023–24

Updated: 18 Aug 2026



Both rural and urban inequality fell between the two survey rounds. Consumption-based Gini is structurally lower than income-based Gini for the same population, since consumption smooths over income volatility — comparisons with countries that report income Gini should account for this.

FIGURE 4.7 NATIONAL ONLY

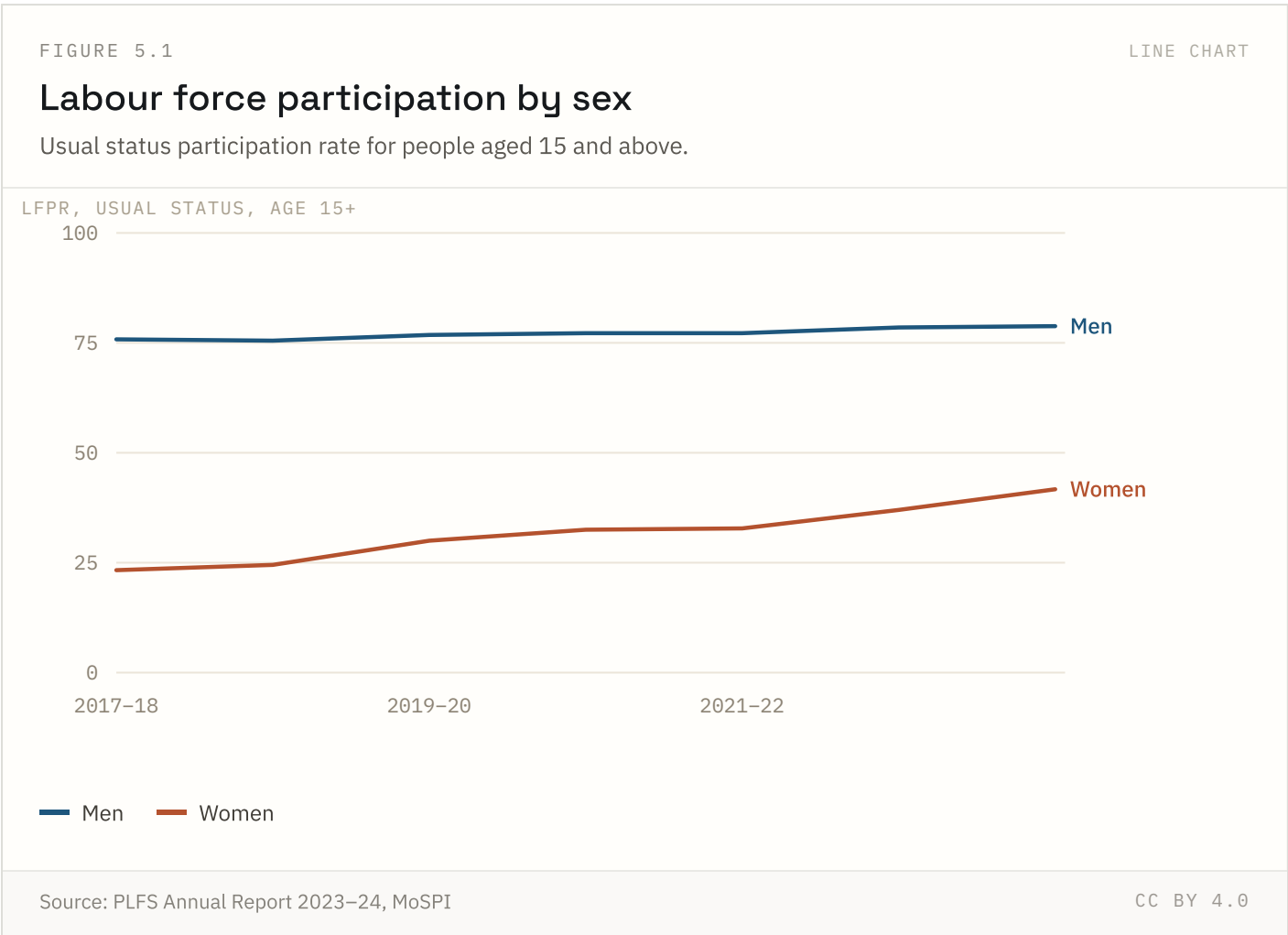


Coverage rose from under a fifth of rural households in 2019 to roughly four-fifths by 2025, one of the fastest rural infrastructure rollouts in this dataset. A reported connection does not guarantee daily supply or potability — independent functionality audits typically report a lower working share.

Employment & labour

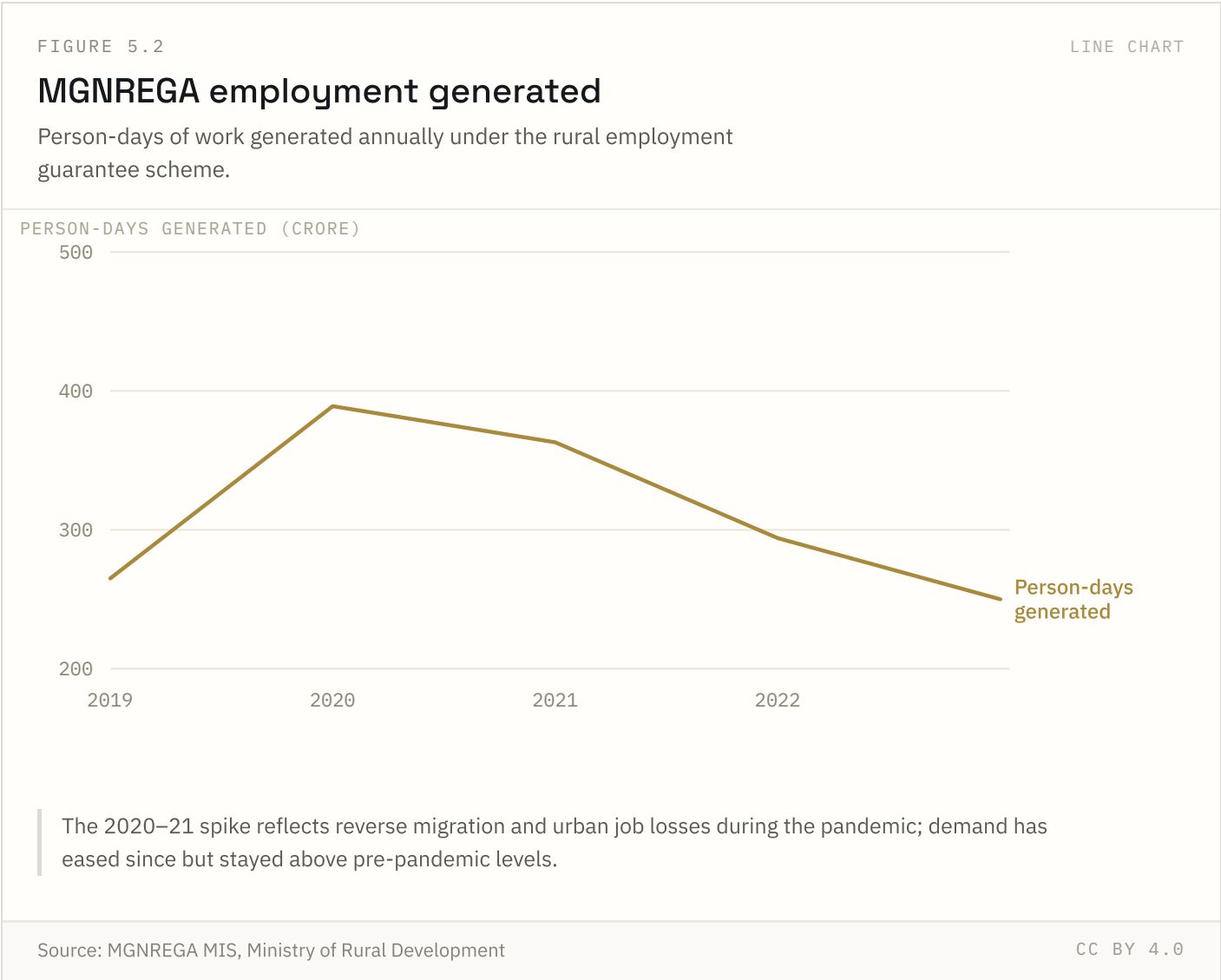
2 of 3 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

FIGURE 5.1 NATIONAL + STATE



Female participation has risen sharply since 2018 on the PLFS usual-status definition, but most of the increase is in unpaid work on family farms and enterprises. Salaried employment for women has grown far more slowly.

FIGURE 5.2 NATIONAL ONLY

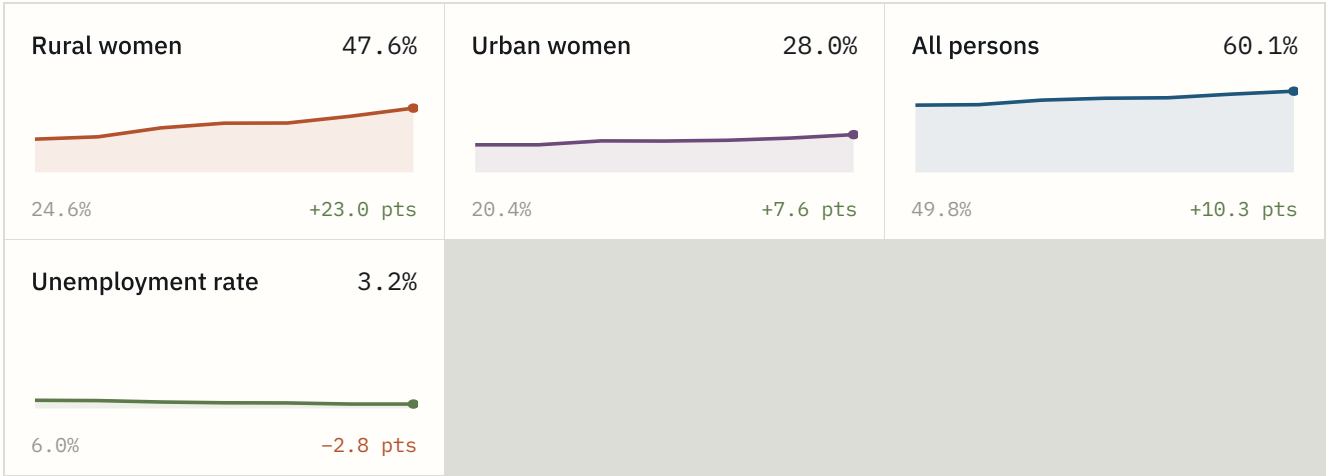


The scheme acts as an automatic stabiliser: person-days jumped 47% in 2020–21 as migrant workers returned to villages during the pandemic, then eased as urban labour markets recovered.

FIGURE 5.3 SMALL MULTIPLES

Labour force participation — small multiples

Four series on one shared 0–65% scale, so the panels can be compared directly.



2017-18 → 2023-24, EACH PANEL ON THE SAME 0-65 % SCALE

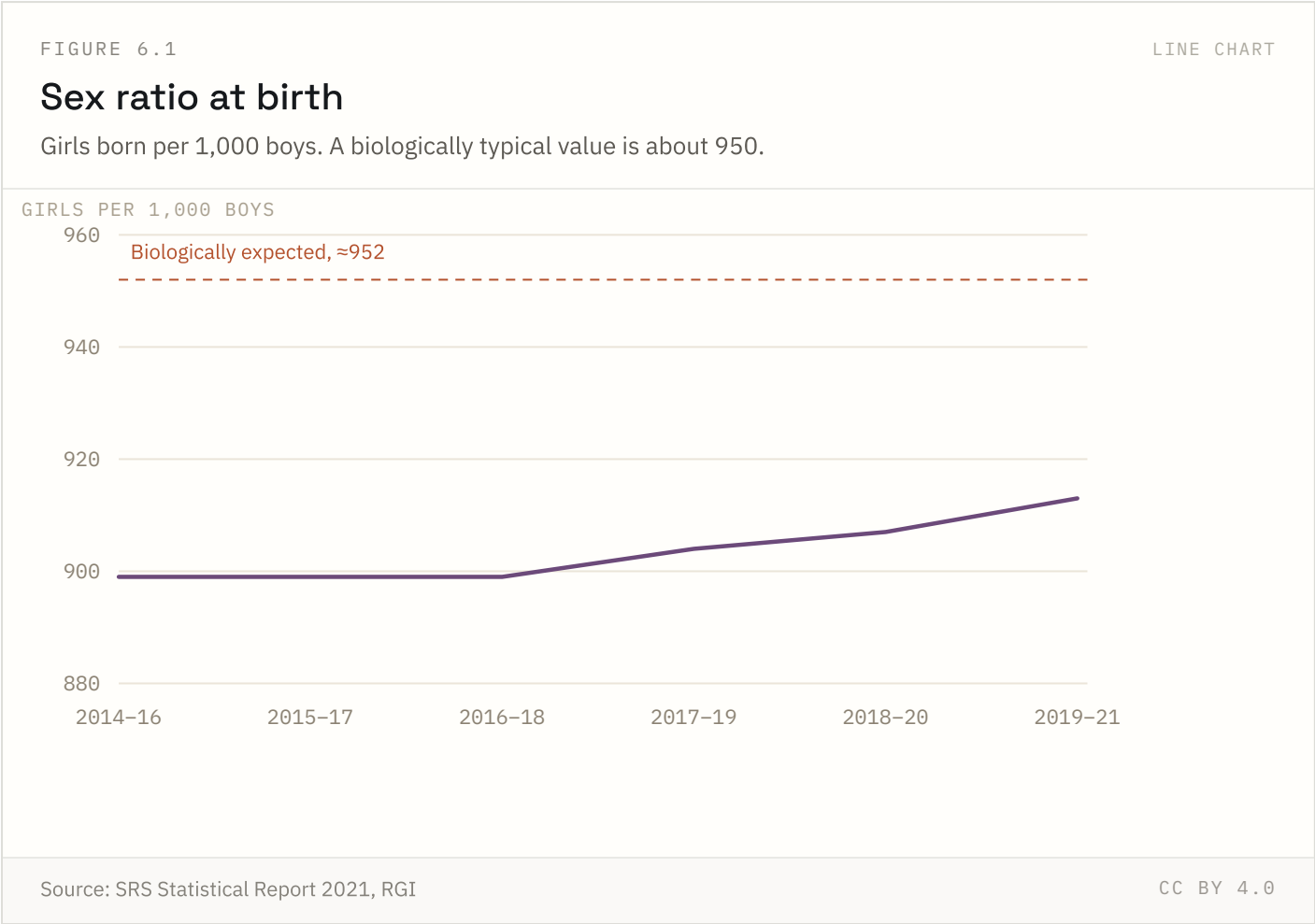
Same scale in every panel, so the panels are directly comparable. Rural women drive almost the whole national increase.

Rural women account for almost the entire national increase: their LFPR nearly doubled from 24.6% to 47.6%, while urban women moved from 20.4% to 28.0%. Part of the change is measurement — PLFS probes unpaid work in family enterprises more carefully than the surveys it replaced.

Gender

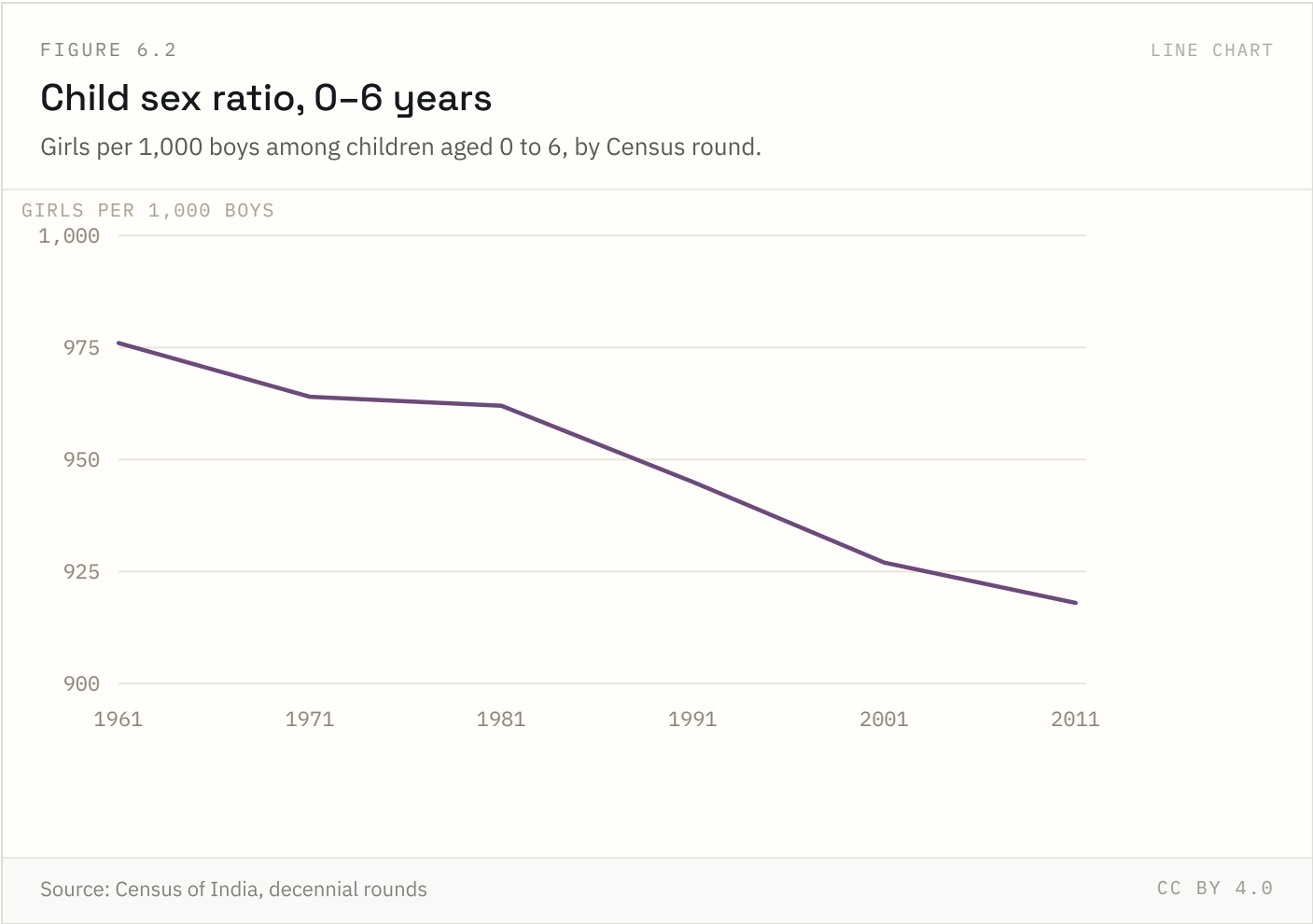
2 of 4 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

FIGURE 6.1 NATIONAL + STATE



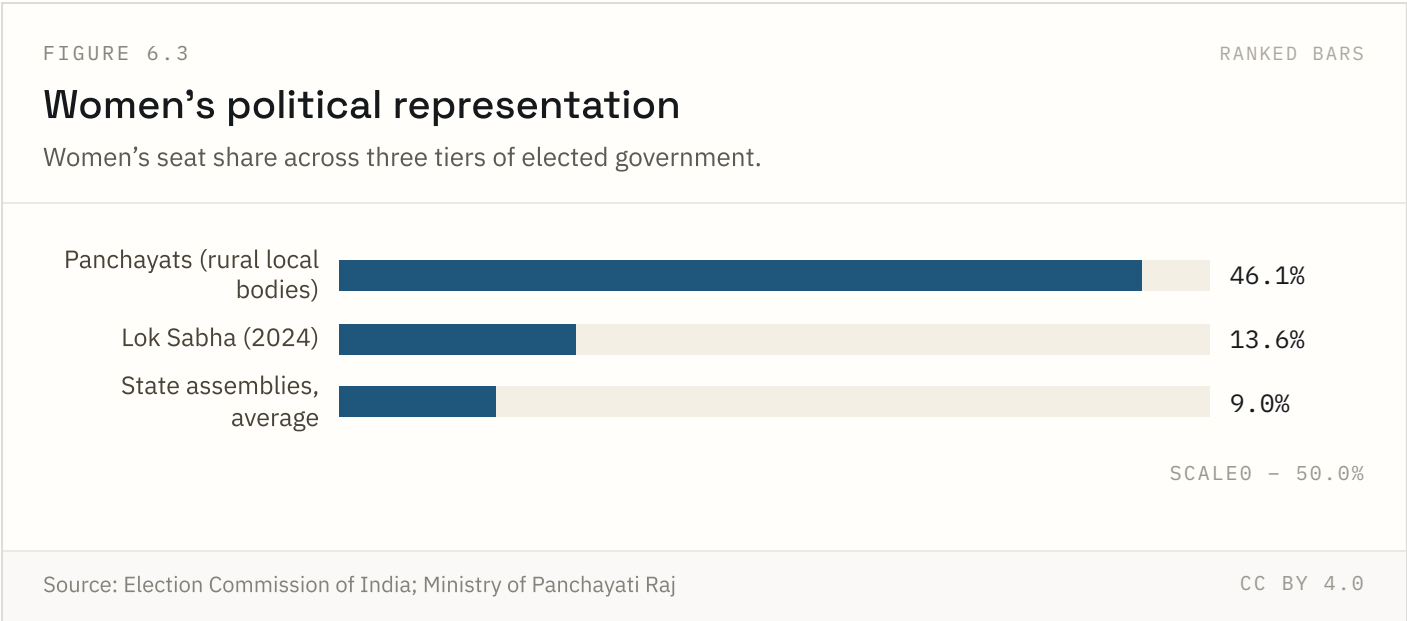
The ratio fell through the 1990s as ultrasound diagnosis spread, bottomed around 2011, and has partially recovered. Recovery is concentrated in Punjab, Haryana and Himachal Pradesh — the states where the deficit was worst.

Source: SRS Statistical Report 2021, RGI Coverage: 1991-2023 Updated: 21 Jul 2026



The child sex ratio fell in every round from 1961 to 2011, most sharply in the 1990s as ultrasound diagnosis spread. Unlike the sex ratio at birth, it also absorbs excess female mortality in early childhood.

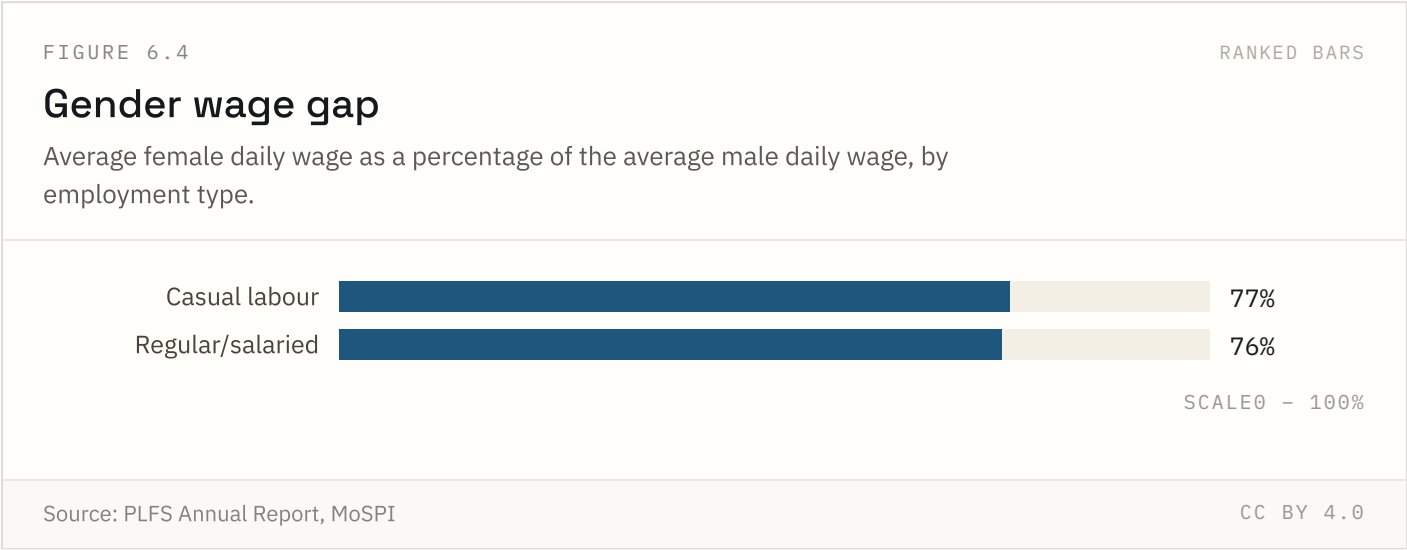
FIGURE 6.3 NATIONAL ONLY



Constitutional reservation (33–50% depending on state) drives the far higher Panchayat figure; no equivalent reservation exists yet for the Lok Sabha or most state assemblies, though a Women’s Reservation Act passed in 2023 is due to apply from the next delimitation.

Source: Election Commission of India; Ministry of Panchayati Raj Coverage: 2024 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

FIGURE 6.4 NATIONAL ONLY

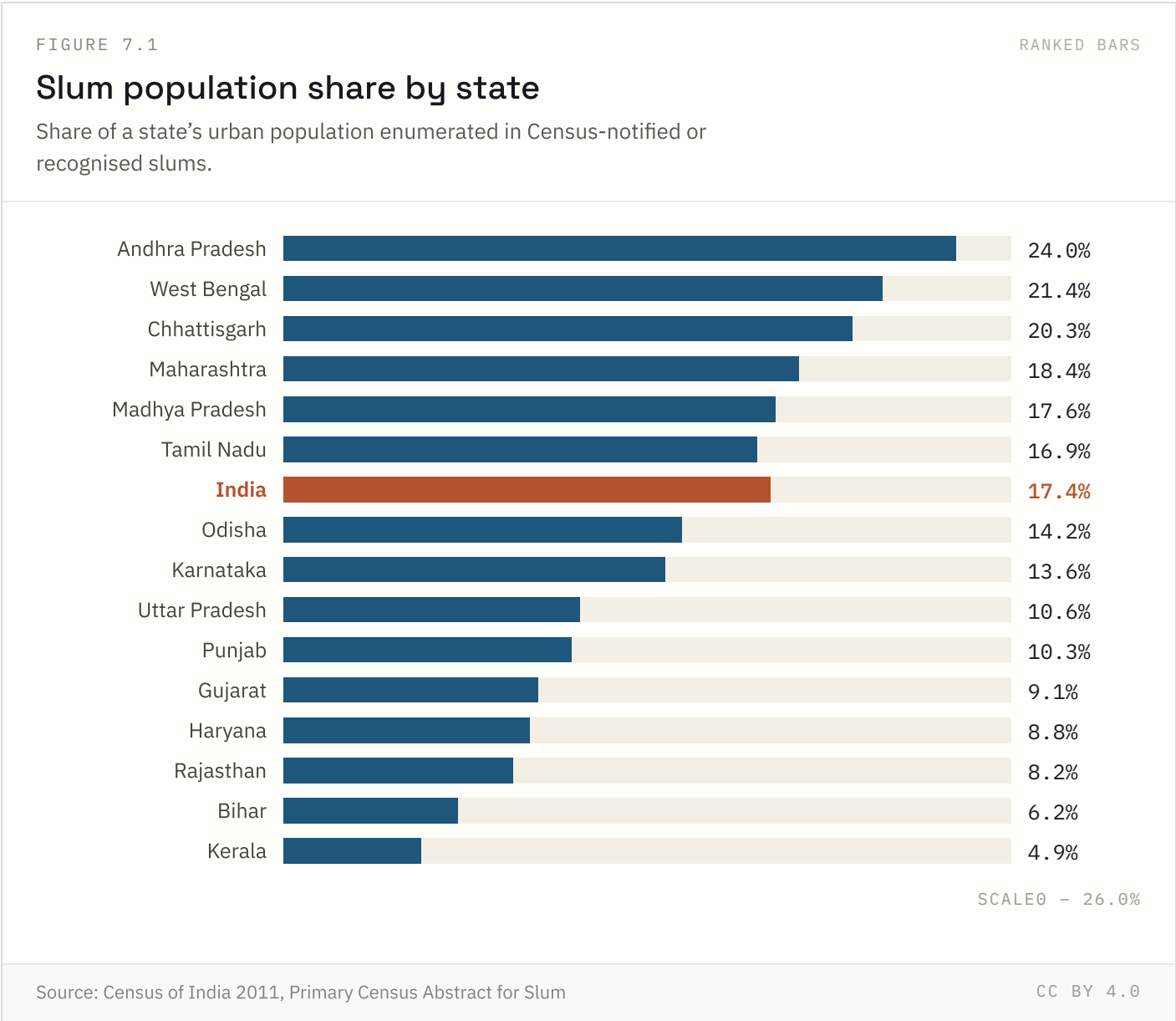


The gap has narrowed slowly over the past decade but persists across both casual and regular/salaried work, even after accounting for differences in sector and hours — unexplained gaps of this kind are consistent with occupational segregation and direct wage discrimination.

Source: PLFS Annual Report, MoSPI Coverage: 2023–24 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

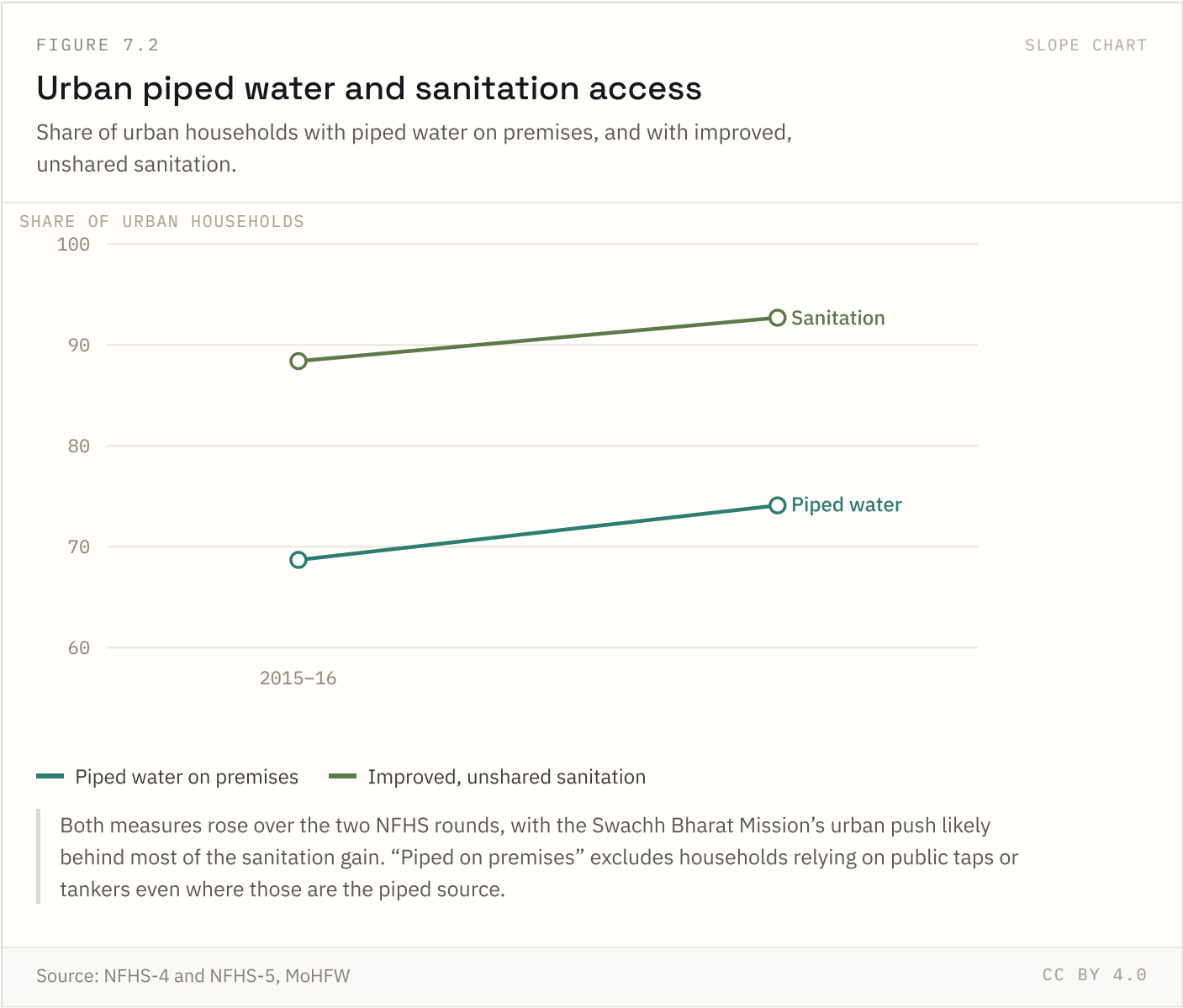
Urban development & housing

1 of 7 indicators in this chapter carry state-level detail; the rest are published at national level only.

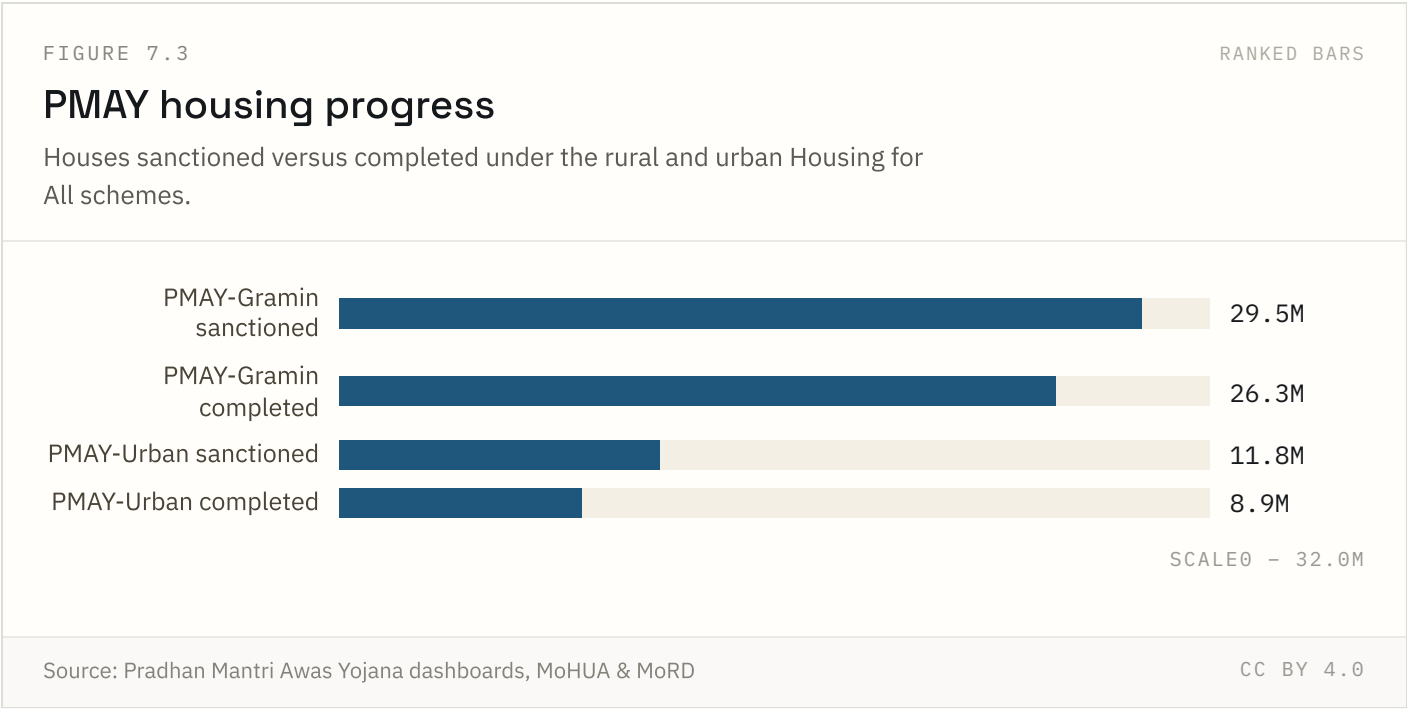


This is the last Census-based slum count available — no Census has been held since 2011, so growth in informal settlements over the past decade is not captured here. Definitions vary by state (notified, recognised and identified slums), which limits strict comparability.

Highest: **Andhra Pradesh** at 24.0%. Lowest: **Kerala** at 4.9%.



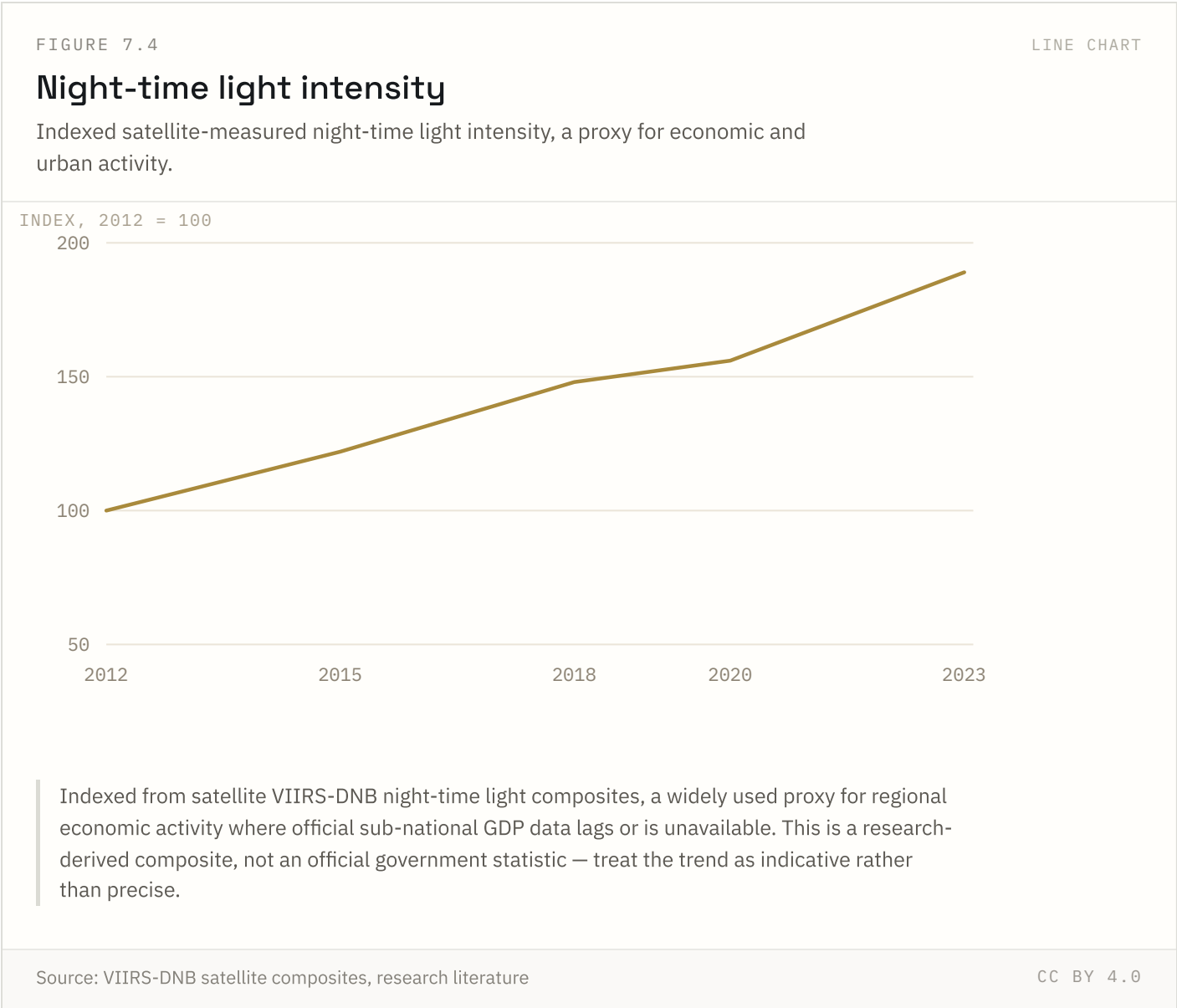
Both series improved between NFHS rounds. “Piped on premises” is stricter than “access to an improved water source” — it excludes households that rely on public taps, tankers or neighbours’ connections even if the underlying source is piped.



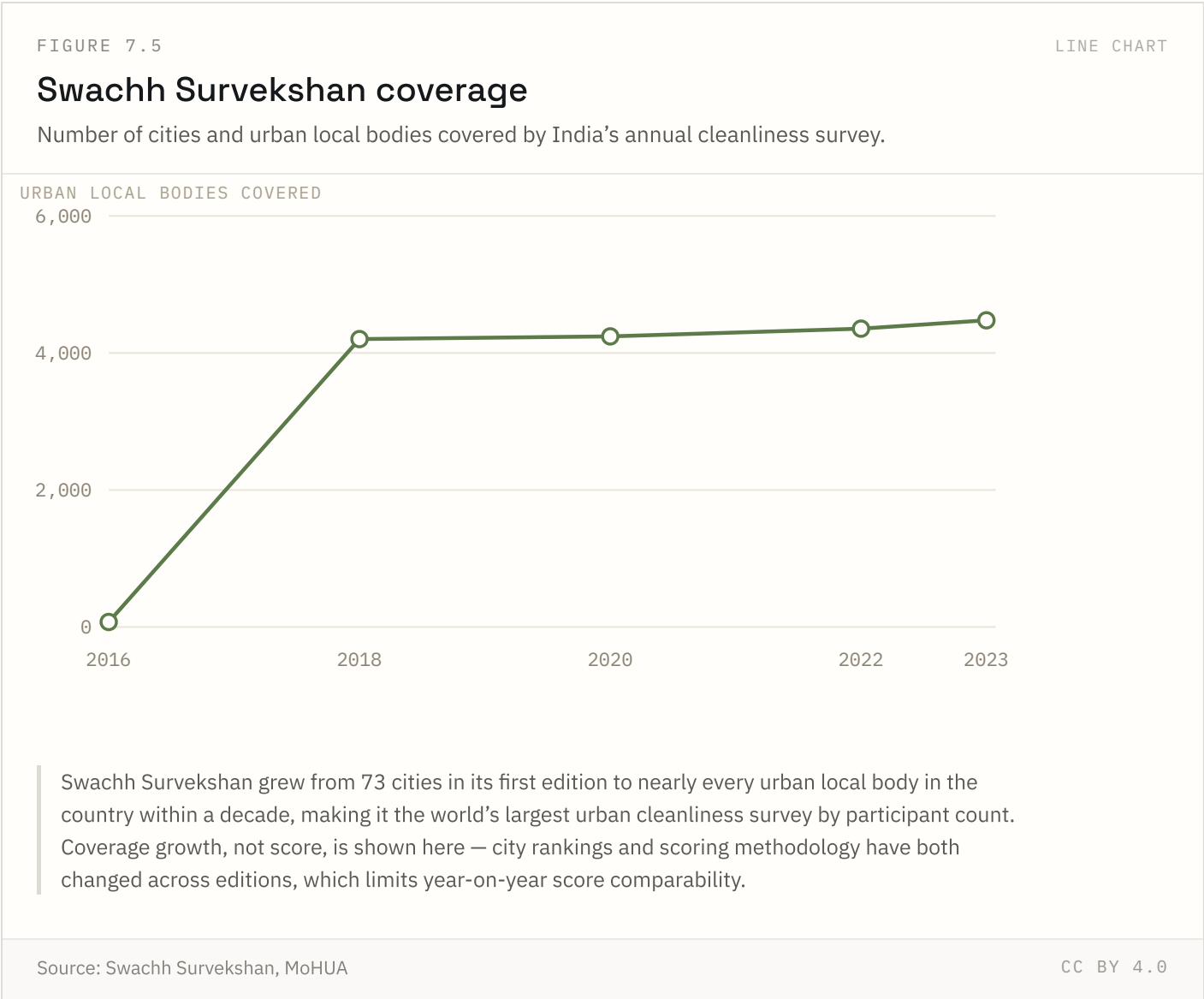
The rural scheme (PMAY-Gramin) is closer to its sanctioned target than the urban scheme (PMAY-Urban), where land acquisition and construction timelines run longer. “Completed” means handed over to the beneficiary, not merely under construction.

Source: Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana dashboards, MoHUA & MoRD Coverage: Cumulative to 2025 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

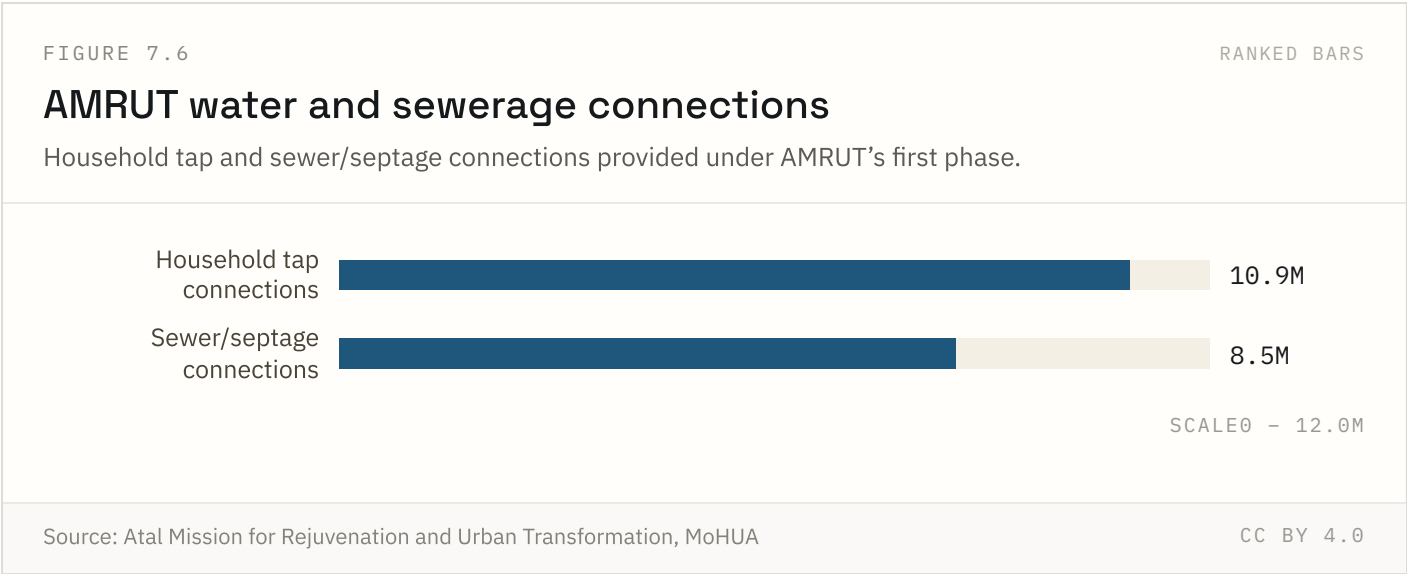
FIGURE 7.4 NATIONAL ONLY



Night-time lights are used by researchers as a fast, sub-national proxy for economic growth where official data is thin or delayed. It captures electrified activity, not output directly, so it can overstate growth in areas that simply gained grid access rather than economic output.



The survey has become close to universal across urban India, which is itself a policy achievement independent of any city’s score. Scoring methodology and weightings have changed across editions, so a city’s rank in different years is not a clean apples-to-apples comparison.

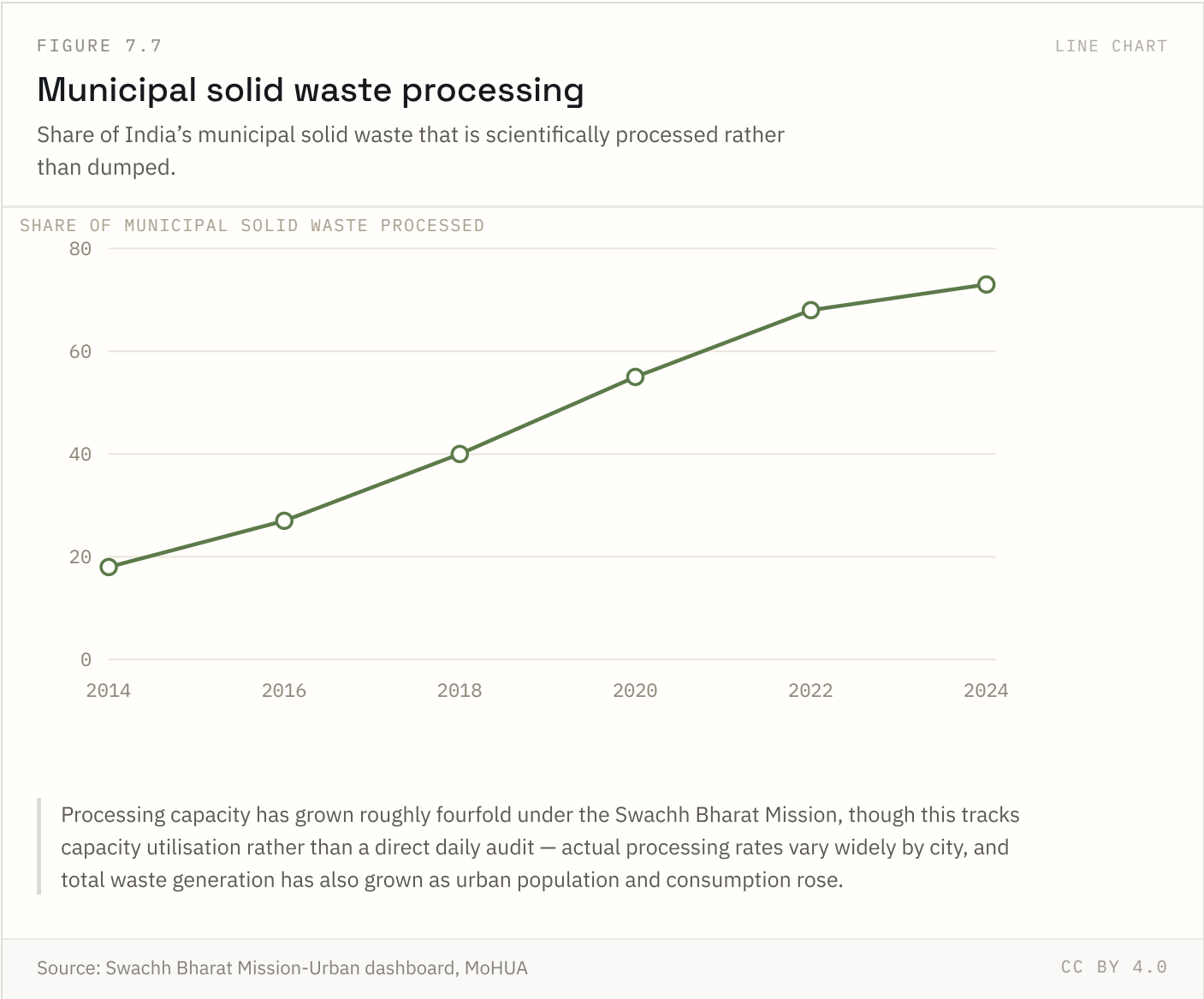


AMRUT 1.0 fell short of its full connection targets by its 2021 close; AMRUT 2.0 (launched 2021) aims at universal coverage. Sewerage lagged water supply throughout the scheme, reflecting the higher cost and longer build time of underground network projects.

Source: Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation, MoHUA Coverage: 2015–2021 (AMRUT 1.0)

Updated: 18 Aug 2026

FIGURE 7.7 NATIONAL ONLY



Processing capacity has grown roughly fourfold since 2014, but total waste generation has also risen with urban population and consumption growth — a rising processed share does not necessarily mean a falling absolute quantity dumped in landfills.

Source: Swachh Bharat Mission-Urban dashboard, MoHUA Coverage: 2014–2024 Updated: 18 Aug 2026

Methodology and limitations

Every figure in this report is reproduced from a published source without adjustment. India Insight Lab does not estimate, model or interpolate the values shown. Each chart carries the source it came from, the years it covers and the date the series was last updated.

Three limitations apply to everything above, and are stated rather than worked around:

- **Geographic depth.** Indicators reach national and, for 18 of 39 series, state level. District and city figures are not included because comparable data is not yet integrated.
- **Comparability across sources.** Series drawn from different sources use different definitions, reference periods and sampling designs. They are shown side by side but are not adjusted onto a common basis.
- **Currency.** Update dates vary by series; the most recent revision date is shown beneath each figure. Some official series lag by several years.

Nothing in this report is projected. Where a series ends, the report ends with it. No forecast, scenario or extrapolation has been added to extend a trend beyond its published data.

References

33 sources used in this report.

1	Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation, MoHUA
2	Census of India
3	Census of India 2011
4	Census of India 2011, Primary Census Abstract for Slum
5	Census of India 2011; SRS 2021, RGI
6	Census of India, D-series migration tables
7	Census of India, decennial rounds
8	Census of India; UN World Population Prospects
9	Census of India; UN World Urbanization Prospects
10	Election Commission of India; Ministry of Panchayati Raj
11	HCES-derived Gini estimates, MoSPI
12	Household Consumption Expenditure Survey (HCES), MoSPI
13	Jal Jeevan Mission dashboard, Ministry of Jal Shakti
14	Jan Suraksha schemes, Department of Financial Services

15	MGNREGA MIS, Ministry of Rural Development
16	NCRB, Accidental Deaths & Suicides in India
17	NFHS-3, NFHS-4 and NFHS-5, IIPS
18	NFHS-4 and NFHS-5, MoHFW
19	NITI Aayog National MPI (2023); World Bank Poverty & Equity Brief (2025)
20	NITI Aayog National MPI — A Progress Review 2023
21	National Population Projections 2011–2036, Registrar General of India
22	PLFS Annual Report 2023–24, MoSPI
23	PLFS Annual Report, MoSPI
24	PLFS Annual Reports 2017–18 to 2023–24, MoSPI
25	Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana dashboards, MoHUA & MoRD
26	SRS Abridged Life Tables 2017–21, RGI
27	SRS Special Bulletin on Maternal Mortality, RGI
28	SRS Statistical Report 2021, RGI
29	Swachh Bharat Mission-Urban dashboard, MoHUA
30	Swachh Survekshan, MoHUA
31	UDISE+, Ministry of Education
32	VIIRS-DNB satellite composites, research literature
33	World Bank Poverty & Equity Brief, India (2025)

Source URLs, licence terms and retrieval dates are not yet recorded for every series. Adding them is scheduled work, and until it is done these references name the publication rather than link to it.